THE SECOND BOOK OF

SAMUEL

David learns of the Battle of Gilboa. His Dirge over Saul and Jonathan

1 And it came to pass after [a] the death of Saul, when David was returned from [b] the slaughter of the Amalekites, and David had abode two days in Ziklag; 2 it came to pass on the third day, that, behold, [c] a man came out of the camp from Saul, [d] with his clothes rent, and earth upon his head: and so it was, when he came to David, that [e] he fell to the earth, and did obeisance. 3 And David said unto him, From whence comest thou? And he said unto him, Out of the camp of Israel am I escaped. 4 And David said unto him, [f] How went the matter? I pray thee, tell me. And he answered, The people are fled from the battle, and many of the people also are fallen and dead; and Saul and Jonathan his son are dead also. 5 And David said unto the young man that told him, How knowest thou that Saul and Jonathan his son are dead? 6 And the young man that told him said, As I happened by chance upon [g] mount Gilboa, behold, [h] Saul was leaning upon his spear; and, lo, the chariots and the horsemen followed hard after him. 7 And when he looked behind him, he saw me, and called unto me. And I answered, Here am I. 8 And he said unto me, Who art thou? And I answered him, [i] I am an Amalekite. 9 And he said unto me, Stand, I pray thee, [1] beside me, and slay me; for [2] anguish hath taken hold of me, because my life is yet whole in me. 10 So I stood [1] beside him, [k] and slew him, because I was sure that he could not live after that he was fallen: and [l] I took the crown that was upon his head, and the bracelet that was on his arm, and have brought them hither unto my lord.

11 Then [m] David took hold on his clothes, and rent them; and likewise all the men that were with him: 12 and they mourned, and wept, and [n] fasted until even, for Saul, and for Jonathan his son, and for the people of Jehovah, and for the house of Israel; because they were fallen by the sword. 13 And David said unto the young man that told him, Whence art thou? And he answered, [o] I am the son of a sojourner, an Amalekite. 14 And David said unto him, How wast thou not afraid [p] to put forth thy hand to destroy Jehovah's anointed? 15 And David called one of the young men, and said, Go near, and fall upon him. [q] And he smote him, so that he died. 16 And David said unto him, [r] Thy blood be on thy head; for [s] thy mouth hath testified against thee, saying, I have slain Jehovah's anointed.

17 And [t] David lamented with this lamentation over Saul and over Jonathan his son 18 (and he bade them teach the children of Judah *the song of* the bow: behold, it is written in [u] the book of [3] Jashar):

19 [4] Thy glory, O Israel, is slain upon thy high places!
[v] How are the mighty fallen!
20 [x] Tell it not in Gath,
Publish it not in the streets of Ashkelon;
Lest [y] the daughters of the Philistines rejoice,
Lest the daughters of [z] the uncircumcised triumph.
21 [a] Ye mountains of Gilboa,
[b] Let there be no dew nor rain upon you, neither fields of offerings:
For there the shield of the mighty was [5] vilely cast away,
The shield of Saul, [6] not [c] anointed with oil.
22 From the [d] blood of the slain, from the fat of the mighty,

[a] 1 S. 31. 6
[b] 1 S. 30. 1, 17, 26
[c] ch. 4. 10
[d] 1 S. 4. 12
[e] 1 S. 25. 23
[f] 1 S. 4. 16
[g] 1 S. 28. 4; 31. 6
[h] 1 S. 31. 2-4
[i] 1 S. 15. 3; 30. 1, 13, 17
[k] Judg. 9. 54
[l] 2 K. 11. 12
[m] Gen. 37. 29, 34
[n] ch. 3. 35
[o] ver. 8
[p] 1 S. 24. 6; 26. 9, 11, 16
[q] ch. 4. 10, 12
[r] ch. 3. 28, 29
[s] ver. 10; Lk. 19. 22
[t] 2 Chr. 35. 25
[u] Josh. 10. 13
[v] ver. 25, 27
[x] 1 S. 31. 8-13; Mic. 1. 10
[y] Ex. 15. 20, 21; 1 S. 18. 6
[z] 1 S. 14. 6
[a] 1 S. 31. 1
[b] Ezek. 31. 15
[c] Is. 21. 5
[d] Dt. 32. 42; Is. 34. 6

[1] Or, *over* [2] Or, *giddiness*
[3] Or, *The Upright* [4] Or, *The gazelle* [5] Or, *defiled* [6] Or, as of one *not anointed*

The [a] bow of Jonathan turned not back,
And the sword of Saul returned not empty.
23 Saul and Jonathan were lovely and pleasant in their lives,
And in their death they were not divided:
They were [b] swifter than eagles,
They were [c] stronger than lions.
24 Ye daughters of Israel, weep over Saul,
Who clothed you in scarlet [1] delicately,
Who put ornaments of gold upon your apparel.
25 [d] How are the mighty fallen in the midst of the battle!
[2] Jonathan is slain upon thy high places.
26 I am distressed for thee, my brother Jonathan:
Very pleasant hast thou been unto me:
Thy [e] love to me was wonderful,
Passing the love of women.
27 [f] How are the mighty fallen,
And [g] the weapons of war perished!

2 And it came to pass after this, that [h] David inquired of Jehovah, saying, Shall I go up into any of the cities of Judah? And Jehovah said unto him, Go up. And David said, Whither shall I go up? And he said, [i] Unto Hebron. 2 So David went up thither, and [k] his two wives also, Ahinoam the Jezreelitess, and Abigail the wife of Nabal the Carmelite. 3 And [l] his men that were with him did David bring up, every man with his household: and they dwelt in the cities of Hebron. 4 And the men of Judah came, and there [m] they anointed David king over the house of Judah.

And they told David, saying, [n] The men of Jabesh-gilead were they that buried Saul. 5 And David sent messengers unto the men of Jabesh-gilead, and said unto them, [o] Blessed be ye of Jehovah, that ye have showed this kindness unto your lord, even unto Saul, and have buried him. 6 And now [p] Jehovah show lovingkindness and truth unto you: and I also will requite you this kindness, because ye have done this thing. 7 Now therefore let your hands be strong, and be ye valiant; for Saul your lord is dead, and also the house of Judah have anointed me king over them.

8 Now [q] Abner the son of Ner, captain of Saul's host, had taken [3] Ish-bosheth the son of Saul, and brought him over to [r] Mahanaim; 9 and he made him king over [s] Gilead, and over the [4] [t] Ashurites, and over [u] Jezreel, and over Ephraim, and over Benjamin, and over all Israel. 10 Ish-bosheth, Saul's son, was forty years old when he began to reign over Israel, and he reigned two years. But the house of Judah followed David. 11 And [v] the time that David was king in Hebron over the house of Judah was seven years and six months.

12 And Abner the son of Ner, and the servants of Ish-bosheth the son of Saul, went out from Mahanaim to [x] Gibeon. 13 And [y] Joab the son of Zeruiah, and the servants of David, went out, and met [5] them by the pool of Gibeon; and they sat down, the one on the one side of the pool, and the other on the other side of the pool. 14 And Abner said to Joab, Let the young men, I pray thee, arise and [z] play before us. And Joab said, Let them arise. 15 Then they arose and went over by number: twelve for Benjamin, and for Ish-bosheth the son of Saul, and twelve of the servants of David. 16 And they caught every one his fellow by the head, and *thrust* his sword in his fellow's side; so they fell down together: wherefore that place was called [6] Helkath-hazzurim, which is in Gibeon. 17 And the battle was very sore that day; and [a] Abner was beaten, and the men of Israel, before the servants of David.

18 And [b] the three sons of Zeruiah were there, Joab, and Abishai, and Asahel: and Asahel was [c] as light of foot [7] as a wild roe. 19 And Asahel pursued after Abner; and in going he turned not to the right hand nor to the left from following Abner. 20 Then Abner looked behind him, and said, Is it thou, Asahel? And he answered, It is I. 21 And Abner said

[a] 1 S. 18. 4
[b] Jer. 4. 13
[c] Judg. 14. 18
[d] ver. 19, 27
[e] 1 S. 18. 1–4
[f] ver. 19, 25
[g] 1 S. 2. 4; Ezek. 39. 9, 10
[h] 1 S. 23. 2, 4, 9–12
[i] Josh. 14. 13; 1 S. 30. 31
[k] 1 S. 25. 42, 43
[l] 1 S. 30. 9; 1 Chr. 12. 1
[m] ch. 5. 3, 5; 1 S. 16. 13
[n] 1 S. 31. 11–13
[o] 1 S. 23. 21
[p] Ex. 34. 6

[q] 1 S. 14. 50
[r] ch. 17. 24; Gen. 32. 2, 10
[s] Josh. 22. 9
[t] Judg. 1. 32
[u] 1 S. 29. 1
[v] ch. 5. 5

[x] Josh. 10. 12; 18. 25
[y] ch. 8. 16; 1 Chr. 2. 16; 11. 6

[z] ver. 16, 17

[a] ch. 3. 1

[b] 1 Chr. 2. 16

[c] 1 Chr. 12. 8; Hab. 3. 19

1 Heb. *with delights.*
2 Or, *O Jonathan, slain &c.*

3 In 1 Chr. 8. 33; 9. 39, *Eshbaal.*
4 The Vulg. and Syr. have, *Geshurites.*
5 Heb. *them together.*
6 That is, *The field of the sharp knives.*
7 Heb. *as one of the roes that are in the field.*

to him, Turn thee aside to thy right hand or to thy left, and lay thee hold on one of the young men, and take thee his [1]armor. But Asahel would not turn aside from following him. 22 And Abner said again to Asahel, Turn thee aside from following me: wherefore should I smite thee to the ground? [a]how then should I hold up my face to Joab thy brother? 23 Howbeit he refused to turn aside: wherefore Abner [b]with the hinder end of the spear smote him in the body, so that the spear came out behind him; and he fell down there, and died in the same place: and it came to pass, that as many as came to the place where [c]Asahel fell down and died stood still.

24 But Joab and Abishai pursued after Abner: and the sun went down when they were come to the hill of Ammah, that lieth before Giah by the way of the wilderness of Gibeon. 25 And the children of Benjamin gathered themselves together after Abner, and became one band, and stood on the top of a hill. 26 Then Abner called to Joab, and said, Shall the sword devour for ever? knowest thou not that it will be bitterness in the latter end? how long shall it be then, ere thou bid the people return from following their brethren? 27 And Joab said, As God liveth, [d]if thou hadst not spoken, surely then [2]in the morning the people had gone away, nor followed every one his brother. 28 So Joab blew the trumpet; and all the people stood still, and pursued after Israel no more, [e]neither fought they any more. 29 And Abner and his men went all that night through the Arabah; and they passed over the Jordan, and went through all Bithron, and came to [f]Mahanaim.

30 And Joab returned from following Abner: and when he had gathered all the people together, there lacked of David's servants nineteen men and Asahel. 31 But the servants of David had smitten of Benjamin, and of Abner's men, *so that* three hundred and threescore men died. 32 And they took up Asahel, and buried him in the sepulchre of his father, which was in Beth-lehem. And Joab and his men went all night, and the day brake upon them at Hebron.

3 Now [g]there was long war between the house of Saul and the house of David: and David waxed stronger and stronger, but the house of Saul waxed weaker and weaker.

2 And [h]unto David were sons born in Hebron: and his first-born was Amnon, of [i]Ahinoam the Jezreelitess; 3 and his second, Chileab, of Abigail the wife of Nabal the Carmelite; and the third, Absalom the son of [k]Maacah the daughter of Talmai [l]king of Geshur; 4 and the fourth, [m]Adonijah the son of Haggith; and the fifth, Shephatiah the son of Abital; 5 and the sixth, Ithream, of Eglah, David's wife. These were born to David in Hebron.

6 And it came to pass, while there was war between the house of Saul and the house of David, that Abner [3]made himself strong in the house of Saul. 7 Now Saul had a concubine, whose name was [n]Rizpah, the daughter of Aiah: and *Ish-bosheth* said to Abner, Wherefore hast thou gone in unto my father's concubine? 8 Then was Abner very wroth for the words of Ish-bosheth, and said, [o]Am I a dog's head that belongeth to Judah? This day do I show kindness unto the house of Saul thy father, to his brethren, and to his friends, and have not delivered thee into the hand of David; and yet thou chargest me this day with [4]a fault concerning this woman. 9 [p]God do so to Abner, and more also, if, [q]as Jehovah hath sworn to David, I do not even so to him; 10 to transfer the kingdom from the house of Saul, and to set up the throne of David over Israel and over Judah, [r]from Dan even to Beer-sheba. 11 And he could not answer Abner another word, because he feared him.

12 And Abner sent messengers to David [5]on his behalf, saying, Whose is the land? saying *also*, Make thy league with me, and, behold, my hand shall be with thee, to bring about all Israel unto thee. 13 And he said, Well; I will make a league with thee; but one thing I require of thee: that is, [s]thou

[a] ch. 3. 27
[b] 1 S. 26. 7
[c] ch. 20. 12
[d] ver. 14
[e] ch. 3. 1
[f] ver. 8

[g] 1 K. 14. 30
[h] 1 Chr. 3. 1–3
[i] 1 S. 25. 42, 43
[k] 1 S. 27. 8
[l] ch. 14. 32; 15. 8
[m] 1 K. 1. 5

[n] ch. 21. 8–11

[o] ch. 9. 8; 1 S. 24. 14

[p] 1 K. 19. 2
[q] 1 S. 15. 28; 25. 28–31

[r] 1 S. 3. 20

[s] Gen. 43. 3

[1] Or, *spoil* See Judg. 14. 19.
[2] Heb. *from the morning.*

[3] Or, *showed himself strong for*
[4] Or, *the fault of this woman*
[5] Or, *where he was*

shalt not see my face, except thou [a]first bring Michal, Saul's daughter, when thou comest to see my face. 14 And David sent messengers to Ish-bosheth, Saul's son, saying, Deliver me my wife Michal, whom I betrothed to me [b]for a hundred foreskins of the Philistines. 15 And Ish-bosheth sent, and took her from her husband, even from [1]Paltiel the son of Laish. 16 And her husband went with her, weeping as he went, and followed her to [c]Bahurim. Then said Abner unto him, Go, return: and he returned.

17 And Abner had communication with [d]the elders of Israel, saying, In times past ye sought for David to be king over you: 18 now then do it; for Jehovah hath spoken of David, saying, [e]By the hand of my servant David I will save my people Israel out of the hand of the Philistines, and out of the hand of all their enemies. 19 And Abner also spake in the ears of Benjamin: and Abner went also to speak in the ears of David in Hebron all that seemed good to Israel, and to [f]the whole house of Benjamin. 20 So Abner came to David to Hebron, and twenty men with him. And David made Abner and the men that were with him a feast. 21 And Abner said unto David, I will arise and go, and [g]will gather all Israel unto my lord the king, that they may make a covenant with thee, and that [h]thou mayest reign over all that thy soul desireth. And David sent Abner away; and he went in peace.

22 And, behold, [i]the servants of David and Joab came from [2]a foray, and brought in a great spoil with them: but Abner was not with David in Hebron; for he had sent him away, and he was gone in peace. 23 When Joab and all the host that was with him were come, they told Joab, saying, Abner the son of Ner came to the king, and he hath sent him away, and he is gone in peace. 24 Then Joab came to the king, and said, What hast thou done? behold, Abner came unto thee; why is it that thou hast sent him away, and he is quite gone? 25 Thou knowest Abner the son of Ner, that he came to deceive thee, and to know [k]thy going out and thy coming in, and to know all that thou doest. 26 And when Joab was come out from David, he sent messengers after Abner, and they brought him back from the [3]well of Sirah: but David knew it not.

27 And when Abner was returned to Hebron, Joab took him aside into the midst of the gate to speak with him quietly, and [l]smote him there in the body, so that he died, for the blood of Asahel his brother. 28 And afterward, when David heard it, he said, I and my kingdom are guiltless before Jehovah for ever of the blood of Abner the son of Ner: 29 [m]let it fall upon the head of Joab, and upon all his father's house; and let there not fail from the house of Joab [n]one that hath an issue, or that is a leper, or that leaneth on a staff, or that falleth by the sword, or that lacketh bread. 30 So Joab and Abishai his brother slew Abner, [o]because he had killed their brother Asahel at Gibeon in the battle.

31 And David said to Joab, and to all the people that were with him, [p]Rend your clothes, and gird you with sackcloth, and mourn before Abner. And king David followed the bier. 32 And they buried Abner in Hebron: and the king lifted up his voice, and wept at the grave of Abner; and all the people wept. 33 And [q]the king lamented for Abner, and said,

Should Abner die as a fool dieth?
34 Thy hands were not bound, nor thy feet put into fetters:
As a man falleth before the children of iniquity, so didst thou fall.

And all the people wept again over him. 35 And all the people came [r]to cause David to eat bread while it was yet day; but David sware, saying, [s]God do so to me, and more also, if I taste bread, or aught else, [t]till the sun be down. 36 And all the people took notice of it, and it pleased them; as whatsoever the king did pleased all the people. 37 So all the people and all Israel understood that day that it was not of the king to slay Abner the son of Ner. 38 And the king said unto his servants, Know ye not that there is a prince and a great man fallen this day in Israel? 39 And I am this day [u]weak, though

[a] 1 S. 18. 20; 19. 11
[b] 1 S. 18. 25, 27
[c] ch. 16. 5
[d] 1 S. 8. 4
[e] 1 S. 9. 16; 15. 28
[f] 1 S. 10. 20, 21
[g] ver. 10, 12
[h] 1 K. 11. 37
[i] 1 S. 27. 8
[k] Dt. 28. 6; 1 S. 29. 6
[l] ch. 2. 23; 20. 9, 10; 1 K. 2. 5
[m] Dt. 21. 6-9; 1 K. 2. 31-33
[n] Lev. 13. 46
[o] ch. 2. 23
[p] Gen. 37. 34; Judg. 11. 35
[q] ch. 1. 17; 2 Chr. 35. 25
[r] ch. 12. 17
[s] 1 S. 3. 17
[t] ch. 1. 12
[u] 1 Chr. 29. 1; 2 Chr. 13. 7

[1] In 1 S. 25. 44, *Palti.* [2] Heb. *the troop.* [3] Or, *cistern*

anointed king; and these men [a] the sons of Zeruiah are too hard for me: [b] Jehovah reward the evil-doer according to his wickedness.

4 And when *Ish-bosheth*, Saul's son, heard that [c] Abner was dead in Hebron, [d] his hands became feeble, and all the Israelites were troubled. 2 And *Ish-bosheth*, Saul's son, *had* two men that were captains of bands: the name of the one was Baanah, and the name of the other Rechab, the sons of Rimmon the Beerothite, of the children of Benjamin (for [e] Beeroth also is reckoned [f] to Benjamin: 3 and the Beerothites fled to [g] Gittaim, and have been sojourners there until this day).

4 Now [h] Jonathan, Saul's son, had a son that was lame of his feet. He was five years old when the [i] tidings came of Saul and Jonathan out of Jezreel; and his nurse took him up, and fled: and it came to pass, as she made haste to flee, that he fell, and became lame. And his name was [1] Mephibosheth.

5 And the sons of Rimmon the Beerothite, Rechab and Baanah, went, and came about the heat of the day [k] to the house of Ishbosheth, as he took his rest at noon. 6 And [2] they came thither into the midst of the house, as though they would have fetched wheat; and [l] they smote him in the body: and Rechab and Baanah his brother escaped. 7 Now when they came into the house, as he lay on his bed in his bedchamber, they smote him, and slew him, and beheaded him, and took his head, and [m] went by the way of the Arabah all night. 8 And they brought the head of Ish-bosheth unto David to Hebron, and said to the king, Behold, the head of Ish-bosheth, [n] the son of Saul, thine enemy, who sought thy life; and Jehovah hath avenged my lord the king this day of Saul, and of his seed. 9 And David answered Rechab and Baanah his brother, the sons of Rimmon the Beerothite, and said unto them, As Jehovah liveth, [o] who hath redeemed my soul out of all adversity, 10 [p] when one told me, saying, Behold, Saul is dead, thinking to have brought good tidings, I took hold of him, and slew him in Ziklag, which was the reward I gave him for his tidings. 11 How much more, when wicked men have slain a righteous person in his own house upon his bed, shall I not now [q] require his blood of your hand, and take you away from the earth? 12 And [r] David commanded his young men, and they slew them, and cut off their hands and their feet, and hanged them up beside the pool in Hebron. But they took the head of Ish-bosheth, [s] and buried it in the grave of Abner in Hebron.

5 [t] Then came all the tribes of Israel to David unto Hebron, and spake, saying, Behold, we are [u] thy bone and thy flesh. 2 In times past, when Saul was king over us, [v] it was thou that leddest out and broughtest in Israel: and Jehovah said to thee, [x] Thou shalt be shepherd of my people Israel, and thou shalt be [3] [y] prince over Israel. 3 So all the elders of Israel came to the king to Hebron; and king David [z] made a covenant with them in Hebron before Jehovah: and [a] they anointed David king over Israel. 4 David was [b] thirty years old when he began to reign, and [c] he reigned forty years. 5 In Hebron [d] he reigned over Judah seven years and six months; and in Jerusalem he reigned thirty and three years over all Israel and Judah.

6 [e] And the king and his men went to [f] Jerusalem against the Jebusites, the inhabitants of the land, who spake unto David, saying, [4] Except thou take away the blind and the lame, thou shalt not come in hither; thinking, David cannot come in hither. 7 Nevertheless David took the stronghold of Zion; the same is [g] the city of David. 8 And David said on that day, Whosoever smiteth the Jebusites, let him get up to the watercourse, [5] and *smite* the lame and the blind, [6] that are hated of David's soul. Wherefore they say, [7] There are the blind and the lame; he cannot come into the house. 9 And David dwelt in the stronghold, and called it [h] the city of David. And David built round about from

[a] ch. 19. 5-7
[b] 1 K. 2. 32-34
[c] ch. 3. 27
[d] Ezr. 4. 4
[e] Josh. 9. 17
[f] Josh. 18. 25
[g] Neh. 11. 33
[h] ch. 9. 3, 6
[i] 1 S. 31. 1-4
[k] ch. 2. 8
[l] ch. 2. 23
[m] ch. 2. 29
[n] 1 S. 24. 4, 25. 29
[o] 1 K. 1. 29
[p] ch. 1. 2, 4, 15

[q] Gen. 9. 5; Ps. 9. 12
[r] ch. 1. 15
[s] ch. 3. 32
[t] 1 Chr. 11. 1-3
[u] ch. 19. 13
[v] 1 S. 18. 5, 13, 16
[x] ch. 7. 7; Gen. 49. 24
[y] 1 S. 25. 30
[z] ch. 3. 21
[a] ch. 2. 4; 1 S. 16. 13
[b] Gen. 41. 46; Num. 4. 3; Lk. 3. 23
[c] 1 K. 2. 11; 1 Chr. 26. 31
[d] ch. 2. 11
[e] 1 Chr. 11. 4-9
[f] Josh. 15. 63; 18. 28; Judg. 1. 21
[g] ch. 6. 12, 16; 1 K. 2. 10; 9. 24
[h] ver. 7

[1] In 1 Chr. 8. 34; 9. 40, *Merib-baal.*
[2] Or, *there came . . . men fetching wheat*
[3] Or, *leader*
[4] Or, *Thou shalt not come in hither, but the blind and the lame shall turn thee away*
[5] Or, *and as for the lame and the blind, that are hated of David's soul—*
[6] Another reading is, *that hate David's soul.*
[7] Or, *The blind and the lame shall not come into the house*

[a] Millo and inward. 10 And [b] David waxed greater and greater; for Jehovah, the God of hosts, was with him.

11 [c] And Hiram king of Tyre sent messengers to David, and cedar-trees, and carpenters, and masons; and [d] they built David a house. 12 And David perceived that Jehovah had established him king over Israel, and that he had exalted his kingdom for his people Israel's sake.

13 And [e] David took him more concubines and wives out of Jerusalem, after he was come from Hebron; and there were yet sons and daughters born to David. 14 And [f] these are the names of those that were born unto him in Jerusalem: Shammua, and Shobab, and Nathan, and Solomon, 15 and Ibhar, and Elishua, and Nepheg, and Japhia, 16 and Elishama, and [1] Eliada, and Eliphelet.

17 And when the Philistines heard that they had anointed David king over Israel, [g] all the Philistines went up to seek David; and David heard of it, and went down to the [h] stronghold. 18 Now the Philistines had come and spread themselves in [i] the valley of Rephaim. 19 And [k] David inquired of Jehovah, saying, Shall I go up against the Philistines? wilt thou deliver them into my hand? And [l] Jehovah said unto David, Go up; for I will certainly deliver the Philistines into thy hand. 20 And David came to Baal-perazim, and David smote them there; and he said, Jehovah hath [2] broken mine enemies before me, like the breach of waters. Therefore he called the name of that place [3] Baal-[m] perazim. 21 And they left their images there; and [n] David and his men took them away.

22 And [o] the Philistines came up yet again, and spread themselves in the valley of Rephaim. 23 And when [p] David inquired of Jehovah, he said, Thou shalt not go up: make a circuit behind them, and come upon them over against the [4] mulberry-trees. 24 And it shall be, when [q] thou hearest the sound of marching in the tops of the mulberry-trees, that then thou shalt bestir thyself; for then is [r] Jehovah gone out before thee to smite the host of the Philistines. 25 And David did so, as Jehovah commanded him, and smote the Philistines from [s] Geba until thou come to [t] Gezer.

6 [u] And David again gathered together all the chosen men of Israel, thirty thousand. 2 And David arose, and went with all the people that were with him, from [v] Baale-judah, to bring up from thence the ark of God, [6] which is called by the [x] Name, even the name of Jehovah of hosts that [7] [y] sitteth *above* the cherubim. 3 And they set the ark of God upon [z] a new cart, and brought it out of the house of Abinadab that was in [8] the hill: and Uzzah and Ahio, the sons of Abinadab, drove the new cart. 4 And [a] they brought it out of the house of Abinadab, which was in [8] the hill, with the ark of God: and Ahio went before the ark. 5 And David and all the house of Israel [b] played before Jehovah [c] with all manner of *instruments made of* [9] fir-wood, and with harps, and with psalteries, and with timbrels, and with [10] castanets, and with cymbals.

6 And when they came to the threshing-floor of [d] Nacon, Uzzah [e] put forth *his hand* to the ark of God, and took hold of it; for the oxen [11] stumbled. 7 And the anger of Jehovah was kindled against Uzzah; and [f] God smote him there for his [12] error; and there he died by the ark of God. 8 And David was displeased, because Jehovah had broken forth upon Uzzah; and he called that place [13] Perez-uzzah, unto this day. 9 And David was afraid of Jehovah that day; and he said, How shall the ark of Jehovah come unto me? 10 So David would not remove the ark of Jehovah unto him into the city of David; but David carried it aside into the house of [g] Obed-edom the Gittite. 11 And the ark of Jehovah remained in the house of Obed-edom the Gittite three months: and Jehovah blessed Obed-edom, and all his house.

12 And it was told king David, saying, Jehovah hath blessed the

[a] 1 K. 9. 15, 24
[b] ch. 3. 1
[c] 1 Chr. 14. 1; 1 K. 5. 2, 10, 18
[d] Ps. 30. title
[e] Dt. 17. 17; 1 Chr. 3. 9.
[f] 1 Chr. 3. 5–8
[g] 1 S. 29. 1
[h] ch. 23. 14; 1 Chr. 11. 16
[i] Gen. 14. 5; Josh. 15. 8; 17. 15; 18. 16
[k] 1 S. 23. 2
[l] ch. 2. 1
[m] Is. 28. 21
[n] 1 Chr. 14. 12
[o] ver. 18
[p] ver. 19
[q] 2 K. 7. 6
[r] Judg. 4. 14

[s] Is. 28. 21
[t] Josh. 12. 12; 21. 21
[u] 1 Chr. 13. 5–14
[v] Josh. 15. 9, 10; 1 S. 7. 1
[x] Lev. 24. 16
[y] Ex. 25. 22
[z] 1 S. 6. 7
[a] 1 S. 7. 1
[b] 1 S. 18. 6, 7
[c] 1 Chr. 13. 8

[d] 1 Chr. 13. 9
[e] Num. 4. 15, 19, 20

[f] 1 S. 6. 19

[g] 1 Chr. 26. 4–8

[1] In 1 Chr. 14. 7, *Beeliada.*
[2] Or, *broken forth upon mine enemies*
[3] That is, *The place of breakings forth.*
[4] Or, *balsam-trees*
[5] In 1 Chr. 14. 16, *Gibeon.*
[6] Heb. *whereupon is called the Name.*
[7] Or, *is enthroned*
[8] Or, *Gibeah*
[9] Or, *cypress-wood*
[10] Or, *sistra*
[11] Or, *were restive* Or, *threw it down*
[12] Or, *rashness*
[13] That is, *The breach of Uzzah.*

house of Obed-edom, and all that pertaineth unto him, because of the ark of God. [a] And David went and brought up the ark of God from the house of Obed-edom into [b] the city of David with joy. 13 And it was so, that, when they that bare the ark of Jehovah had gone six paces, he sacrificed an ox and a fatling. 14 And [c] David danced before Jehovah with all his might; and David was [d] girded with a linen ephod. 15 So David and all the house of Israel brought up the ark of Jehovah with shouting, and with the sound of the trumpet.

16 And it was so, as the ark of Jehovah came into the city of David, that [e] Michal the daughter of Saul looked out at the window, and saw king David leaping and dancing before Jehovah; and she despised him in her heart. 17 And they brought in the ark of Jehovah, and set it [f] in its place, in the midst of the tent that David had pitched for it; and [g] David offered burnt-offerings and peace-offerings before Jehovah. 18 And when David had made an end of offering the burnt-offering and the peace-offerings, [h] he blessed the people in the name of Jehovah of hosts. 19 And he dealt among all the people, even among the whole multitude of Israel, both to men and women, to every one a cake of bread, and a portion [1] *of flesh*, and a cake of raisins. So all the people departed every one to his house.

20 Then David returned to bless his household. And Michal the daughter of Saul came out to meet David, and said, How glorious was the king of Israel to-day, [i] who uncovered himself to-day in the eyes of the handmaids of his servants, as one of the vain fellows shamelessly uncovereth himself! 21 And David said unto Michal, [k] *It was* before Jehovah, who chose me above thy father, and above all his house, to appoint me prince over the people of Jehovah, over Israel: therefore will I play before Jehovah. 22 And I will be yet more vile than this, and will be base in mine own sight: but of the handmaids of whom thou hast spoken, of them shall I be had in honor. 23 And Michal the daughter of Saul had no child unto the day of her death.

[1] Or, of wine

[a] 1 Chr. 15. 25–16. 3
[b] 1 K. 8. 1
[c] Ex. 15. 20, 21; Judg. 11. 34
[d] Ex. 19. 6; 1 S. 2. 18, 28
[e] ch. 3. 14
[f] 1 Chr. 15. 1; 2 Chr. 1. 4
[g] 1 K. 8. 62–65
[h] 1 K. 8. 14, 15
[i] ver. 14, 16
[k] 1 S. 13. 14; 15. 28

[l] 1 Chr. 17. 1–27
[m] ver. 17; ch. 12. 1; 1 K. 1. 22; 1 Chr. 29. 29; 2 Chr. 9. 29
[n] ch. 5. 11
[o] Ex. 26. 1
[p] 1 K. 8. 17, 18
[q] 1 K. 5. 3, 4; 8. 19
[r] Josh. 18. 1; 1 K. 8. 16
[s] Ex. 40. 18, 34
[t] Lev. 26. 11, 12
[u] ch. 5. 2
[v] 1 S. 16. 11, 12; Ps. 78. 70, 71
[x] ch. 6. 21

[y] ch. 5. 10

[z] Ps. 18. 37–42

[a] Ex. 15. 17, Is. 5. 2, 7

[b] Ps. 89. 22, 23; Is. 60. 18

[c] Judg. 2. 14–16; 1 S. 12. 9–11
[d] ver. 1

[e] ver. 27; 1 S. 25. 28
[f] 1 K. 2. 1

[g] 1 K. 6. 12; 8. 19

[h] Is. 9. 7; 49. 8
[i] Heb. 1. 5; Ps. 89. 26, 27

7 [l] And it came to pass, when the king dwelt in his house, and Jehovah had given him rest from all his enemies round about, 2 that the king said unto [m] Nathan the prophet, See now, I dwell in [n] a house of cedar, but the ark of God [o] dwelleth within curtains. 3 And Nathan said to the king, [p] Go, do all that is in thy heart; for Jehovah is with thee. 4 And it came to pass the same night, that the word of Jehovah came unto Nathan, saying, 5 Go and tell my servant David, Thus saith Jehovah, [q] Shalt thou build me a house for me to dwell in? 6 for [r] I have not dwelt in a house since the day that I brought up the children of Israel out of Egypt, even to this day, but have walked [s] in a tent and in a tabernacle. 7 [t] In all places wherein I have walked with all the children of Israel, spake I a word with [2] any of the tribes of Israel, [u] whom I commanded to be shepherd of my people Israel, saying, Why have ye not built me a house of cedar? 8 Now therefore thus shalt thou say unto my servant David, Thus saith Jehovah of hosts, [v] I took thee from the [3] sheepcote, from following the sheep, that [x] thou shouldest be [4] prince over my people, over Israel; 9 and [y] I have been with thee whithersoever thou wentest, and [z] have cut off all thine enemies from before thee; and I will make thee a great name, like unto the name of the great ones that are in the earth. 10 And I will appoint a place for my people Israel, and [a] will plant them, that they may dwell in their own place, and be moved no more; [b] neither shall the children of wickedness afflict them any more, as at the first, 11 and *as* [c] from the day that I commanded judges to be over my people Israel; and [d] I [5] will cause thee to rest from all thine enemies. Moreover Jehovah telleth thee that [e] Jehovah will make thee a house. 12 [f] When thy days are fulfilled, and thou shalt sleep with thy fathers, I will set up thy seed after thee, that shall proceed out of thy bowels, and I will establish his kingdom. 13 [g] He shall build a house for my name, and [h] I will establish the throne of his kingdom for ever. 14 [i] I will be his father, and he shall be my

[2] In 1 Chr. 17. 6, *any of the judges.*
[3] Or, *pasture* [4] Or, *leader* [5] Or, *have caused*

son: [a] if he commit iniquity, I will chasten him with the rod of men, and with the stripes of the children of men; 15 but my lovingkindness shall not depart from him, [b] as I took it from Saul, whom I put away before thee. 16 And [c] thy house and thy kingdom shall be made sure for ever before thee: thy throne shall be established for ever. 17 According to all these words, and according to all this vision, so did Nathan speak unto David.

18 Then David the king went in, and sat before Jehovah; and he said, [d] Who am I, O Lord Jehovah, and what is my house, that thou hast brought me thus far? 19 And this was yet a small thing in thine eyes, O Lord Jehovah; [e] but thou hast spoken also of thy servant's house for a great while to come; [1] and [f] this *too* after the manner of men, O Lord Jehovah! 20 And what can David say more unto thee? for [g] thou knowest thy servant, O Lord Jehovah. 21 [h] For thy word's sake, and according to thine own heart, hast thou wrought all this greatness, to make thy servant know it. 22 Wherefore [i] thou art great, O Jehovah God: for [k] there is none like thee, neither is there any God besides thee, [l] according to all that we have heard with our ears. 23 [2] And [m] what one nation in the earth is like thy people, even like Israel, whom God went to redeem unto himself for a people, and to make him a name, and [n] to do great things for you, and terrible things for thy land, before [o] thy people, whom [p] thou redeemedst to thee out of Egypt, *from* the nations and their gods? 24 And [q] thou didst establish to thyself thy people Israel to be a people unto thee for ever; and [r] thou, Jehovah, becamest their God. 25 And now, O Jehovah God, the word that thou hast spoken concerning thy servant, and concerning his house, confirm thou it for ever, and do as thou hast spoken. 26 And [s] let thy name be magnified for ever, saying, Jehovah of hosts is God over Israel; and the house of thy servant David shall be established before thee. 27 For thou, O Jehovah of hosts, the God of Israel, hast revealed to thy servant, saying, [t] I will build thee a house: therefore hath thy servant [3] found in his heart to pray this prayer unto thee. 28 And now, O Lord Jehovah, thou art God, and [u] thy words are truth, and thou hast promised this good thing unto thy servant: 29 now therefore [4] let it please thee to bless the house of thy servant, that it may continue for ever before thee; for thou, O Lord Jehovah, hast spoken it: and [v] with thy blessing let the house of thy servant be blessed for ever.

8 [x] And after this it came to pass, that David smote the Philistines, and subdued them: and David took [5] the bridle of the mother city out of the hand of the Philistines.

2 And [y] he smote [z] Moab, and measured them with the line, making them to lie down on the ground; and he measured two lines to put to death, and one full line to keep alive. And [a] the Moabites became servants to David, and [b] brought tribute.

3 David smote also [c] Hadadezer the son of Rehob, king of Zobah, as [d] he went to recover his dominion at [6] the River. 4 And David took from him a thousand and seven hundred horsemen, and twenty thousand footmen: and David [e] hocked all the chariot horses, but reserved of them for a hundred chariots. 5 And when [7] [f] the Syrians of Damascus came to succor Hadadezer king of Zobah, David smote of [7] the Syrians two and twenty thousand men. 6 Then David put garrisons in [7] Syria of Damascus; and [7] [g] the Syrians became servants to David, and brought tribute. And [h] Jehovah [8] gave victory to David whithersoever he went. 7 And David took the shields of gold that were on the servants of Hadadezer, and brought them to Jerusalem. 8 And from [9] Betah and from [i] Berothai, cities of Hadadezer, king David took exceeding much brass.

9 And when Toi king of [k] Hamath heard that David had smitten all the host of Hadadezer, 10 then Toi sent [10] Joram his son unto king

[a] 1 K. 11. 34; Ps. 89. 30–33
[b] 1 S. 15. 23; 16. 14
[c] ver. 13; Ps. 89. 36, 37
[d] Ex. 3. 11; 1 S. 18. 18
[e] ver. 11–16; 1 Chr. 17. 17
[f] Is. 55. 8, 9
[g] 1 S. 16. 7; Jn. 21. 17
[h] 1 Chr. 17. 19
[i] Dt. 3. 24; Ps. 48. 1; 86. 10
[k] Ex. 15. 11; 1 S. 2. 2
[l] Ex. 10. 2; Ps. 44. 1
[m] Dt. 4. 32–38
[n] Dt. 10. 21
[o] Dt. 15. 15
[p] Dt. 9. 26
[q] Dt. 32. 6
[r] Gen. 17. 7, 8; Ex. 6. 7
[s] Ps. 72. 18, 19

[t] ver. 13
[u] Ex. 34. 6; Jn. 17. 17
[v] Num. 6. 24–26
[x] 1 Chr. 18
[y] Num. 24. 17
[z] 1 S. 22. 3, 4
[a] ver. 6; 1 K. 4. 21; 2 K. 3. 4
[b] 2 K. 17. 3
[c] ch. 10. 16, 19; 1 S. 14. 47
[d] ch. 10. 15–19

[e] Josh. 11. 6, 9
[f] 1 K. 11. 23–25; 15. 18

[g] ver. 2

[h] ch. 3. 18

[i] Ezek. 47. 16

[k] 1 K. 8. 65; 2 Chr. 8. 4

[1] Or, *and is this the law of man, O Lord Jehovah?*
[2] Or, *And who is like thy people, like Israel, a nation that is alone in the earth &c.*
[3] Or, *been bold*
[4] Or, *begin and bless*
[5] Or, *Metheg-ammah*
[6] Another reading is, *the river Euphrates.*
[7] Heb. *Aram.*
[8] Or, *saved David*
[9] In. 1 Chr. 18. 8, *Tibhath.*
[10] In. 1 Chr. 18. 10, *Hadoram.*

David, to [1] salute him, and to bless him, because he had fought against Hadadezer and smitten him: for Hadadezer [2] had wars with Toi. And [3] *Joram* brought with him vessels of silver, and vessels of gold, and vessels of brass: 11 [a] these also did king David dedicate unto Jehovah, with the silver and gold that he dedicated of all the nations which he subdued; 12 of [4] Syria, and [b] of Moab, and [c] of the children of Ammon, and of [d] the Philistines, and of [e] Amalek, and of the spoil of Hadadezer, son of Rehob, king of Zobah.

13 And [f] David gat him a name when he returned from smiting [5] the Syrians in [g] the Valley of Salt, even eighteen thousand men. 14 And he put garrisons in Edom; throughout all Edom put he garrisons, and [h] all the Edomites became servants to David. And [i] Jehovah [6] gave victory to David whithersoever he went.

15 And David reigned over all Israel; and David executed justice and righteousness unto all his people. 16 And Joab the son of Zeruiah was over the host; and [k] Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud was [7] [l] recorder; 17 and [m] Zadok the son of Ahitub, and Ahimelech the son of Abiathar, were [n] priests; and Seraiah was [8] [o] scribe; 18 and [p] Benaiah the son of Jehoiada [9] *was over* the [q] Cherethites and the Pelethites; and David's sons were [10] [r] chief ministers.

9 And David said, Is there yet any that is left of the house of Saul, [s] that I may show him kindness for Jonathan's sake? 2 And there was of the house of Saul a servant whose name was Ziba, and they called him unto David; and the king said unto him, Art thou [t] Ziba? And he said, Thy servant is he. 3 And the king said, Is there not yet any of the house of Saul, that I may show the [u] kindness of God unto him? And Ziba said unto the king, [v] Jonathan hath yet a son, who is lame of his feet. 4 And the king said unto him, Where is he? And Ziba said unto the king, Behold, he is [z] in the house of Machir the son of Ammiel, in Lo-debar. 5 Then king David sent, and fetched him out of the house of Machir the son of Ammiel, from Lo-debar. 6 And [y] Mephibosheth, the son of Jonathan, the son of Saul, came unto David, and [z] fell on his face, and did obeisance. And David said, Mephibosheth. And he answered, Behold, thy servant! 7 And David said unto him, Fear not; for [a] I will surely show thee kindness for Jonathan thy father's sake, and [b] will restore thee all the [11] land of Saul thy father; and [c] thou shalt eat bread at my table continually. 8 And he did obeisance, and said, What is thy servant, that thou shouldest look upon such [d] a dead dog as I am?

9 Then the king called to Ziba, Saul's servant, and said unto him, [e] All that pertained to Saul and to all his house have I given unto thy master's son. 10 And thou shalt till the land for him, thou, and thy sons, and thy servants; and thou shalt bring in *the fruits*, that thy master's son may have bread to eat: but [f] Mephibosheth thy master's son [g] shall eat bread alway at my table. Now Ziba had fifteen sons and twenty servants. 11 Then said Ziba unto the king, According to all that my lord the king commandeth his servant, so shall thy servant do. [12] As for Mephibosheth, *said the king*, he shall eat at my table, as one of the king's sons. 12 And Mephibosheth had a young son, whose name was [h] Mica. And all that dwelt in the house of Ziba were servants unto Mephibosheth. 13 So Mephibosheth dwelt in Jerusalem; for [i] he did eat continually at the king's table. And [k] he was lame in both his feet.

10 [l] And it came to pass after this, that [m] the king of the children of Ammon died, and Hanun his son reigned in his stead. 2 And David said, I will show kindness unto Hanun the son of [n] Nahash, as his father showed kindness unto me. So David sent by his servants to comfort him concerning his father. And David's servants came into the land of the children of Ammon. 3 But the princes of the children of Ammon said unto Hanun their lord, Thinkest thou that David doth honor thy

[a] 1 K. 7. 51
[b] ver. 2
[c] ch. 10. 14
[d] ch. 5. 17–25
[e] 1 S. 27. 8; 30. 17–20
[f] ch. 7. 9
[g] 2 K. 14. 7
[h] Gen. 27. 37–40; Num. 24. 17, 18
[i] ver. 6
[k] 1 K. 4. 3
[l] 2 K. 18. 18, 37
[m] 1 Chr. 6. 4–8
[n] 1 Chr. 16. 39, 40
[o] 2 K. 18. 18
[p] 1 K. 4. 4
[q] ch. 15. 18; 20. 7, 23; 1 S. 30. 14; 1 K. 1. 38, 44
[r] 1 Chr. 18. 17
[s] 1 S. 20. 14–17, 42
[t] ch. 16. 1–4; 19. 17, 29
[u] 1 S. 20. 14
[v] ch. 4. 4
[z] ch. 17. 27–29

[y] ch. 16. 4; 19. 24–30
[z] 1 S. 25. 23
[a] ver. 1, 3
[b] ch. 12. 8
[c] ch. 19. 28; 1 K. 2. 7; 2 K. 25. 29
[d] ch. 16. 9
[e] ch. 16. 4; 19. 29
[f] ver. 7, 11, 13
[g] ch. 19. 28; 1 K. 2. 7
[h] 1 Chr. 8. 34

[i] ver. 7, 11
[k] ver. 3

[l] 1 Chr. 19. 1–19
[m] 1 S. 11. 1

[n] 1 S. 11. 1

[1] Heb. *ask him of his welfare.*
[2] Heb. *was a man of wars.*
[3] Heb. *in his hand were.* [4] Heb. *Aram.*
[5] *Edom*, in 1 Chr. 18. 11, 12; Ps. 60. title.
[6] Or, *saved David* [7] Or, *chronicler*
[8] Or, *secretary*
[9] So in ch. 20. 23, and 1 Chr. 18. 17. The Hebrew text has, *and the Cherethites &c.*
[10] Or, *priests*

[11] Heb. *field.*
[12] Or, *But Mephibosheth eateth &c.*

father, in that he hath sent comforters unto thee? [a] hath not David sent his servants unto thee to search the city, and to spy it out, and to overthrow it? 4 So Hanun took David's servants, and [b] shaved off the one half of their beards, and [c] cut off their garments in the middle, even to their buttocks, and sent them away. 5 When they told it unto David, he sent to meet them; for the men were greatly ashamed. And the king said, Tarry at Jericho until your beards be grown, and then return.

6 And when the children of Ammon saw that [d] they were become odious to David, the children of Ammon sent and [e] hired the Syrians of [f] Beth-rehob, and the [g] Syrians of Zobah, twenty thousand footmen, and the king of [h] Maacah with a thousand men, and the men of Tob twelve thousand men. 7 And when David heard of it, he sent Joab, and all the host of the mighty men. 8 And the children of Ammon came out, and put the battle in array [i] at the entrance of the gate; and the Syrians of Zobah and of Rehob, and the men of [k] Tob and Maacah, were by themselves [l] in the field.

9 Now when Joab saw that [1] the battle was set against him before and behind, he chose of all the choice men of Israel, and put them in array against the Syrians: 10 and the rest of the people he committed into the hand of [2] Abishai his brother; and he put them in array against the children of Ammon. 11 And he said, If the Syrians be too strong for me, then thou shalt help me; but if the children of Ammon be too strong for thee, then I will come and help thee. 12 [m] Be of good courage, and [n] let us play the man for our people, and for the cities of our God: and [o] Jehovah do that which seemeth him good. 13 So Joab and the people that were with him drew nigh unto the battle against the Syrians: and [p] they fled before him. 14 And when the children of Ammon saw that the Syrians were fled, they likewise fled before Abishai, and entered into the city. [q] Then Joab returned from the children of Ammon, and came to Jerusalem.

15 And when the Syrians saw that they were put to the worse before Israel, they gathered themselves together. 16 [r] And [3] Hadarezer sent, and brought out the Syrians that were beyond the River: and they came to Helam, with [s] Shobach the captain of the host of Hadarezer at their head. 17 And it was told David; and he gathered all Israel together, and passed over the Jordan, and came to Helam. And the Syrians set themselves in array against David, and fought with him. 18 And the Syrians fled before Israel; and David slew of the Syrians [t] *the men of* seven hundred chariots, and forty thousand horsemen, and smote Shobach the captain of their host, so that he died there. 19 And when all the kings that were servants to Hadarezer saw that they were put to the worse before Israel, [u] they made peace with Israel, and served them. So the Syrians feared to help the children of Ammon any more.

11 [v] And it came to pass, [z] at the return of the year, at the time when kings go out *to battle*, that David sent Joab, and his servants with him, and all Israel; and they destroyed the children of Ammon, and [y] besieged Rabbah. But David tarried at Jerusalem.

2 And it came to pass at eventide, that [z] David arose from off his bed, and walked upon [a] the roof of the king's house: and from the roof he saw a woman bathing; and the woman was very beautiful to look upon. 3 And David sent and inquired after the woman. And one said, Is not this [b] Bath-sheba, the daughter of Eliam, the wife of [c] Uriah the Hittite? 4 And David sent messengers, and took her; and she came in unto him, and [d] he lay with her (for [e] she was purified from her uncleanness); and she returned unto her house. 5 And the woman conceived; and she sent and told David, and said, [f] I am with child.

6 And David sent to Joab, *saying*, Send me Uriah the Hittite. And Joab sent Uriah to David. 7 And when Uriah was come unto him, [g] David asked of him how Joab did, and how the people fared, and how the war prospered. 8 And David said to Uriah, Go

[a] Gen. 42. 9, 16
[b] Is. 15. 2; Jer. 41. 5
[c] Is. 20. 4
[d] Gen. 34. 30; 1 S. 27. 12
[e] ch. 8. 3, 5; 2 K. 7. 6
[f] Gen. 36. 37; Judg. 18. 28
[g] ch. 8. 3
[h] Dt. 3. 14
[i] 1 Chr. 19. 9
[k] Judg. 11. 3, 5
[l] Josh. 13. 9, 16
[m] Dt. 31. 6; Josh. 1. 6
[n] 1 Cor. 16. 13
[o] 1 S. 3. 18
[p] 1 K. 20. 13–21
[q] ch. 11. 1

[r] ch. 8. 3–8
[s] 1 Chr. 19. 16
[t] 1 Chr. 19. 18
[u] ch. 8. 6

[v] 1 Chr. 20. 1
[z] ch. 10. 14; 1 K. 20. 22, 26

[y] ch. 12. 26–28; Jer. 49. 2, 3; Am. 1. 14

[z] ch. 4. 5, 7
[a] Dt. 22. 8; 1 S. 9. 25; Mt. 24. 17; Acts 10. 9

[b] 1 Chr. 3. 5

[c] ch. 23. 39

[d] Ps. 51. title; Jas. 1. 14, 15
[e] Lev. 12. 2–5; 15. 19–28; 18. 19

[f] Lev. 20. 10; Dt. 22. 22

[g] Gen. 37. 14; 1 S. 17. 22

[1] Heb. *the face of the battle was against.*
[2] Heb. *Abshai.*
[3] In ch. 8. 3, *Hadadezer.*

down to thy house, and [a] wash thy feet. And Uriah departed out of the king's house, and there followed him [b] a [1] mess *of food* from the king. 9 But Uriah slept [c] at the door of the king's house with all the servants of his lord, and went not down to his house. 10 And when they had told David, saying, Uriah went not down unto his house, David said unto Uriah, Art thou not come from a journey? wherefore didst thou not go down unto thy house? 11 And Uriah said unto David, [d] The ark, and Israel, and Judah, abide in booths; and my lord Joab, and [e] the servants of my lord, are encamped in the open field; shall I then go into my house, to eat and to drink, and to lie with my wife? [f] as thou livest, and as thy soul liveth, I will not do this thing. 12 And David said to Uriah, Tarry here to-day also, and to-morrow I will let thee depart. So Uriah abode in Jerusalem [2] that day, and the morrow. 13 And when David had called him, he did eat and drink before him; and he made him drunk: and at even he went out to lie on his bed [g] with the servants of his lord, but went not down to his house.

14 And it came to pass in the morning, that David [h] wrote a letter to Joab, and sent it by the hand of Uriah. 15 And he wrote in the letter, saying, Set ye Uriah in the forefront of the [3] hottest battle, and retire ye from him, [i] that he may be smitten, and die. 16 And it came to pass, when Joab [4] kept watch upon the city, that he assigned Uriah unto the place where he knew that valiant men were. 17 And the men of the city went out, and fought with Joab: and there fell some of the people, even of the servants of David; and [k] Uriah the Hittite died also. 18 Then Joab sent and told David all the things concerning the war; 19 and he charged the messenger, saying, When thou hast made an end of telling all the things concerning the war unto the king, 20 it shall be that, if the king's wrath arise, and he say unto thee, Wherefore went ye so nigh unto the city to fight? knew ye not that they would shoot from the wall? 21 who [l] smote Abimelech the son of [5] Jerubbesheth? did not a woman cast an upper millstone upon him from the wall, so that he died at Thebez? why went ye so nigh the wall? then shalt thou say, Thy servant Uriah the Hittite is dead also.

22 So the messenger went, and came and showed David all that Joab had sent him for. 23 And the messenger said unto David, The men prevailed against us, and came out unto us into the field, and we were upon them even unto the entrance of the gate. 24 And the shooters shot at thy servants from off the wall; and some of the king's servants are dead, and thy servant Uriah the Hittite is dead also. 25 Then David said unto the messenger, Thus shalt thou say unto Joab, Let not this thing displease thee, for the sword devoureth one as well as another; make thy battle more strong against the city, and overthrow it: and encourage thou him.

26 And when the wife of Uriah heard that Uriah her husband was dead, [m] she made lamentation for her husband. 27 And when the mourning was past, David sent and took her home to his house, and [n] she became his wife, and bare him a son. But [o] the thing that David had done displeased Jehovah.

12 And Jehovah sent [p] Nathan unto David. And [q] he came unto him, and [r] said unto him, There were two men in one city; the one rich, and the other poor. 2 The rich man had exceeding many flocks and herds; 3 but the poor man had nothing, save [s] one little ewe lamb, which he had bought and nourished up: and it grew up together with him, and with his children; it did eat of his own morsel, and drank of his own cup, and lay in his bosom, and was unto him as a daughter. 4 And there came a traveller unto the rich man, and he spared to take of his own flock and of his own herd, to dress for the wayfaring man that was come unto him, but took the poor man's lamb, and dressed it for the man that was come to him. 5 [t] And David's anger was greatly kindled against

[a] Gen. 43. 24; Lk. 7. 44
[b] Gen. 43. 34
[c] 1 K. 14. 27, 28
[d] ch. 7. 2, 6
[e] ch. 20. 6
[f] ch. 4. 9; 14. 19
[g] ver. 9
[h] 1 K. 21. 8–10
[i] ch. 12. 9
[k] ver. 21

[l] Judg. 9. 50–54

[m] Gen. 50. 10; Dt. 34. 8; 1 S. 31. 13
[n] ch. 12. 9
[o] Ps. 51. 4, 5

[p] ch. 7. 2, 4, 17
[q] Ps. 51. title
[r] ch. 14. 4–7; 1 K. 20. 35–41

[s] ch. 11. 3

[t] 1 K. 20. 39, 40

[1] Or, *present from*
[2] Or, *that day. And on the morrow David called him, and he &c.*
[3] Heb. *strong.*
[4] Or, *observed*
[5] In Judg. 6. 32, *Jerubbaal*

the man; and he said to Nathan, As Jehovah liveth, the man that hath done this is [1] [a] worthy to die: 6 and he shall restore the lamb [b] fourfold, because he did this thing, and because he had no pity.

7 And Nathan said to David, [c] Thou art the man. Thus saith Jehovah, the God of Israel, [d] I anointed thee king over Israel, and I delivered thee out of the hand of Saul; 8 and I gave thee [e] thy master's house, and thy master's wives into thy bosom, and gave thee the house of Israel and of Judah; and if that had been too little, I would have added unto thee such and such things. 9 Wherefore [f] hast thou despised the word of Jehovah, to do that which is evil in his sight? [g] thou hast smitten Uriah the Hittite with the sword, and [h] hast taken his wife to be thy wife, and hast slain him with the sword of the children of Ammon. 10 Now therefore [i] the sword shall never depart from thy house, because thou hast despised me, and hast taken the wife of Uriah the Hittite to be thy wife. 11 Thus saith Jehovah, Behold, I will raise up evil against thee out of thine own house; and [k] I will take thy wives before thine eyes, and give them unto thy neighbor, and he shall lie with thy wives in the sight of this sun. 12 For [l] thou didst it secretly: but [m] I will do this thing before all Israel, and before the sun. 13 And David said unto Nathan, [n] I have sinned against Jehovah. And Nathan said unto David, Jehovah also hath [o] put away thy sin; thou shalt not die. 14 Howbeit, because by this deed thou hast [p] given great occasion to the enemies of Jehovah to blaspheme, the child also that is born unto thee shall surely die. 15 And Nathan departed unto his house.

And [q] Jehovah struck the child that Uriah's wife bare unto David, and it was very sick. 16 David therefore besought God for the child; and David fasted, and went in, and [r] lay all night upon the earth. 17 And [s] the elders of his house arose, *and stood* beside him, to raise him up from the earth: but he would not, neither did he eat bread with them. 18 And it came to pass on the seventh day, that the child died. And the servants of David feared to tell him that the child was dead; for they said, Behold, while the child was yet alive, we spake unto him, and he hearkened not unto our voice: [2] how will he then vex himself, if we tell him that the child is dead! 19 But when David saw that his servants were whispering together, David perceived that the child was dead; and David said unto his servants, Is the child dead? And they said, He is dead. 20 Then David arose from the earth, and [t] washed, and anointed himself, and changed his apparel; and he came into the house of Jehovah, and worshipped: then he came to his own house; and when he required, they set bread before him, and he did eat. 21 Then said his servants unto him, What thing is this that thou hast done? thou didst fast and weep for the child, while it was alive; but when the child was dead, thou didst rise and eat bread. 22 And he said, While the child was yet alive, [u] I fasted and wept: for I said, [v] Who knoweth whether Jehovah will not be gracious to me, that the child may live? 23 But now he is dead, wherefore should I fast? can I bring him back again? [x] I shall go to him, but [y] he will not return to me.

24 And David comforted Bathsheba his wife, and went in unto her, and lay with her: and she bare a son, and [3] [z] he called his name Solomon. And Jehovah loved him; 25 and he sent by the hand of Nathan the prophet; and he called his name [4] Jedidiah, for Jehovah's sake.

26 [a] Now Joab fought against Rabbah of the children of Ammon, and took the royal city. 27 And Joab sent messengers to David, and said, I have fought against Rabbah; yea, I have taken the city of waters. 28 Now therefore gather the rest of the people together, and encamp against the city, and take it; lest I take the city, and [5] it be called after my name. 29 And David gathered all the people together, and went

[a] 1 S. 26. 16
[b] Ex. 22. 1
[c] 1 K. 20. 42
[d] 1 S. 16. 13
[e] ch. 9. 7
[f] 1 S. 15. 23, 26
[g] ch. 11. 14–17, 27
[h] ch. 11. 27
[i] ch. 13. 28; 18. 14; 1 K. 2. 25
[k] ch. 16. 21, 22
[l] ch. 11. 4–15
[m] ch. 16. 22
[n] ch. 24. 10; 1 S. 15. 24, 30; Lk. 18. 13
[o] Prov. 28. 13; Lev. 20. 10; 24. 17; Mic. 7. 18
[p] Is. 52. 5; Rom. 2. 24
[q] 1 S. 25. 38
[r] ch. 13. 31; Neh. 1. 4
[s] Gen. 24. 2

[t] Mt. 6. 17

[u] Is. 38. 1–3
[v] Jon. 3. 9

[x] Gen. 37. 35
[y] Job 7. 8–10

[z] 1 Chr. 22. 9

[a] 1 Chr. 20. 1–3

[1] Heb. *a son of death.*

[2] Or, *how then shall we tell him that the child is dead, so that he do himself some harm?*
[3] Another reading is, *she called.*
[4] That is, *Beloved of Jehovah.*
[5] Heb. *my name be called upon it.*

to Rabbah, and fought against it, and took it. 30 And he took the crown of [1]their king from off his head; and the weight thereof was a talent of gold, and *in it were* precious stones; and it was set on David's head. And he brought forth the spoil of the city, exceeding much. 31 And he brought forth the people that were therein, and [a]put them [2]under saws, and [2]under harrows of iron, and [2]under axes of iron, and [3]made them pass through the [4]brickkiln: and thus did he unto all the cities of the children of Ammon. And David and all the people returned unto Jerusalem.

13 And it came to pass after this, that [b]Absalom the son of David had a fair sister, whose name was [c]Tamar; and [d]Amnon the son of David loved her. 2 And Amnon was so vexed that he fell sick because of his sister Tamar; for she was a virgin; and it seemed hard to Amnon to do anything unto her. 3 But Amnon had a friend, whose name was Jonadab, the son of [e]Shimeah, David's brother: and Jonadab was a very subtle man. 4 And he said unto him, Why, O son of the king, art thou thus lean [5]from day to day? wilt thou not tell me? And Amnon said unto him, I love Tamar, my brother Absalom's sister. 5 And Jonadab said unto him, Lay thee down on thy bed, and feign thyself sick: and when thy father cometh [f]to see thee, say unto him, Let my sister Tamar come, I pray thee, and give me bread to eat, and dress the food in my sight, that I may see it, and eat it from her hand. 6 So Amnon lay down, and feigned himself sick: and when the king was come to see him, Amnon said unto the king, Let my sister Tamar come, I pray thee, and [g]make me a couple of cakes in my sight, that I may eat from her hand.

7 Then David sent home to Tamar, saying, Go now to thy brother Amnon's house, and dress him food. 8 So Tamar went to her brother Amnon's house; and he was laid down. And she took dough, and kneaded it, and made cakes in his sight, and did bake the cakes. 9 And she took the pan, and poured them out before him; but he refused to eat. And Amnon said, [h]Have out all men from me. And they went out every man from him. 10 And Amnon said unto Tamar, Bring the food into the chamber, that I may eat from thy hand. And Tamar took the cakes which she had made, and brought them into the chamber to Amnon her brother. 11 And when she had brought them near unto him to eat, he took hold of her, and said unto her, Come, lie with me, my sister. 12 And she answered him, Nay, my brother, do not [6]force me; for [i]no such thing ought to be done in Israel: do not thou this [k]folly. 13 And I, whither shall I carry my shame? and as for thee, thou wilt be as one of the fools in Israel. Now therefore, I pray thee, speak unto the king; for [l]he will not withhold me from thee. 14 Howbeit he would not hearken unto her voice; but being stronger than she, he forced her, and lay with her.

15 Then Amnon hated her with exceeding great hatred; for the hatred wherewith he hated her was greater than the love wherewith he had loved her. And Amnon said unto her, Arise, be gone. 16 And she said unto him, [7]Not so, because this great wrong in putting me forth is *worse* than the other that thou didst unto me. But he would not hearken unto her. 17 Then he called his servant that ministered unto him, and said, Put now this woman out from me, and bolt the door after her. 18 And she had [8][m]a garment of divers colors upon her; for with such robes were the king's daughters that were virgins apparelled. Then his servant brought her out, and bolted the door after her. 19 And [n]Tamar put ashes on her head, and [o]rent her garment of divers colors that was on her; and [p]she laid her hand on her head, and went her way, crying aloud as she went.

20 And Absalom her brother said unto her, Hath [9]Amnon thy brother been with thee? but now hold thy peace, my sister: he is

[a] Heb. 11. 37
[b] ch. 3. 2, 3; 1 Chr. 3. 2
[c] 1 Chr. 3. 9
[d] ch. 3. 2
[e] 1 S. 16. 9
[f] 2 K. 8. 29
[g] Gen. 18. 6

[h] Gen. 45. 1
[i] Lev. 20. 17
[k] Judg. 19. 23; 20. 6

[l] Gen. 20. 12

[m] Gen. 37. 3, 23; Judg. 5. 30

[n] 1 S. 4. 12; Esth. 4. 1; Jer. 2. 37
[o] ch. 1. 11; Gen. 37. 29
[p] Jer. 2. 37

[1] Or, *Malcam* See Zeph. 1. 5. [2] Or, *to*
[3] Or, with a slight change in the Hebrew text, *made them labor at* [4] Or, *brick-mould*
[5] Heb. *morning by morning.*
[6] Heb. *humble.*
[7] Or, Think *not there is occasion for this great wrong in putting me forth*, which is worse *&c.*
[8] Or, *a long garment with sleeves*
[9] Heb. *Amnon.*

thy brother; take not this thing to heart. So Tamar remained desolate [a]in her brother Absalom's house. 21 But when king David heard of all these things, he was very wroth. 22 And Absalom spake unto Amnon [b]neither good nor bad; for Absalom hated Amnon, because he had forced his sister Tamar.

23 And it came to pass after two full years, that Absalom [c]had sheep-shearers in Baal-hazor, which is beside Ephraim: and Absalom invited all the king's sons. 24 And Absalom came to the king, and said, Behold now, thy servant hath sheep-shearers; let the king, I pray thee, and his servants go with thy servant. 25 And the king said to Absalom, Nay, my son, let us not all go, lest we be burdensome unto thee. And he pressed him: howbeit he would not go, but blessed him. 26 Then [d]said Absalom, If not, I pray thee, let my brother Amnon go with us. And the king said unto him, Why should he go with thee? 27 But Absalom pressed him, and he let Amnon and all the king's sons go with him. 28 And Absalom commanded his servants, saying, Mark ye now, [e]when Amnon's heart is merry with wine; and when I say unto you, Smite Amnon, then kill him; fear not; have not I commanded you? be courageous, and be valiant. 29 And the servants of Absalom did unto Amnon as Absalom had commanded. Then all the king's sons arose, and every man gat him up upon [f]his mule, and fled.

30 And it came to pass, while they were in the way, that the tidings came to David, saying, Absalom hath slain all the king's sons, and there is not one of them left. 31 Then the king arose, and [g]rent his garments, and [h]lay on the earth; and all his servants stood by with their clothes rent. 32 And [i]Jonadab, the son of Shimeah, David's brother, answered and said, Let not my lord suppose that they have killed all the young men the king's sons; for Amnon only is dead: for by the appointment of Absalom this hath been determined from the day that he forced his sister Tamar. 33 Now therefore let not my lord the king [k]take the thing to his heart, to think that all the king's sons are dead; for Amnon only is dead.

34 But [l]Absalom fled. And [m]the young man that kept the watch lifted up his eyes, and looked, and, behold, there came much people by the way of the hill-side behind him. 35 And Jonadab said unto the king, Behold, the king's sons are come: as thy servant said, so it is. 36 And it came to pass, as soon as he had made an end of speaking, that, behold, the king's sons came, and lifted up their voice, and wept: and the king also and all his servants wept [1] very sore.

37 But [n]Absalom fled, and went to [o]Talmai the son of [2]Ammihur, king of [p]Geshur. And *David* mourned for his son every day. 38 [q]So Absalom fled, and went to Geshur, and was there three years. 39 And *the soul of* king David longed to go forth unto Absalom: for [r]he was comforted concerning Amnon, seeing he was dead.

14 Now Joab the son of Zeruiah perceived that [s]the king's heart was toward Absalom. 2 And Joab sent to [t]Tekoa, and fetched thence a wise woman, and said unto her, I pray thee, [u]feign thyself to be a mourner, and put on mourning apparel, I pray thee, and [v]anoint not thyself with oil, but be as a woman that hath a long time mourned for the dead: 3 and go in to the king, and speak on this manner unto him. So Joab put [x]the words in her mouth.

4 And when the woman of Tekoa spake to the king, she fell on her face to the ground, and [y]did obeisance, and said, [z]Help, O king. 5 And the king said unto her, What aileth thee? And she answered, [a]Of a truth I am a widow, and my husband is dead. 6 And thy handmaid had two sons, and they two strove together in the field, and there was none to part them, but the one smote the other, and killed him. 7 And, behold, [b]the whole family is risen against thy handmaid, and they say, Deliver him that smote his brother, that we may kill him for the life of his brother whom he slew, [c]and so destroy the heir also. Thus will they quench my coal which is left, and will leave to my husband

[a] ch. 14. 24
[b] Gen. 31. 24
[c] 1 S. 25. 7
[d] ch. 3. 27; 11. 13–15
[e] Judg. 19. 6, 9, 22; 1 S. 25. 36–38
[f] ch. 18. 9; 1 K. 1. 33, 38
[g] ch. 1. 11
[h] ch. 12. 16
[i] ver. 3–5
[k] ch. 19. 19

[l] ver. 37, 38
[m] ch. 18. 24

[n] ver. 34
[o] ch. 3. 3
[p] ch. 14. 23, 32
[q] ver. 34

[r] ch. 12. 19–23

[s] ch. 13. 39

[t] ch. 23. 26; 2 Chr. 11. 6; Am. 1. 1
[u] 1 K. 20. 35–43

[v] ch. 12. 20

[x] ver. 19

[y] 1 S. 25. 23
[z] 2 K. 6. 26–28

[a] ver. 5–21 with ch. 12. 1–7

[b] Num. 35. 19; Dt. 19. 12, 13

[c] Mt. 21. 38

[1] Heb. *with a very great weeping.*
[2] Another reading is, *Ammihud.*

neither name nor remainder upon the face of the earth.

8 And the king said unto the woman, Go to thy house, and I will give charge concerning thee. 9 And the woman of Tekoa said unto the king, My lord, O king, [a] the iniquity be on me, and on my father's house; and [b] the king and his throne be guiltless. 10 And the king said, Whosoever saith aught unto thee, bring him to me, and he shall not touch thee any more. 11 Then said she, I pray thee, let the king remember Jehovah thy God, [c] that the avenger of blood destroy not any more, lest they destroy my son. And he said, [d] As Jehovah liveth, there shall not one hair of thy son fall to the earth.

12 Then the woman said, Let thy handmaid, I pray thee, speak a word unto my lord the king. And he said, Say on. 13 And the woman said, [e] Wherefore then hast thou devised such a thing against the people of God? for in speaking this word the king is as one that is guilty, in that the king doth not fetch home again [f] his banished one. 14 For [g] we must needs die, and are [h] as water spilt on the ground, which cannot be gathered up again; neither doth God take away life, but deviseth means, that he [i] that is banished be not an outcast from him. 15 Now therefore seeing that I am come to speak this word unto my lord the king, it is because the people have made me afraid: and thy handmaid said, I will now speak unto the king; it may be that the king will perform the request of his servant. 16 For the king will hear, to deliver his servant out of the hand of the man that would destroy me and my son together out of [k] the inheritance of God. 17 Then thy handmaid said, Let, I pray thee, the word of my lord the king be [1] comfortable; for as [2] [l] an angel of God, so is my lord the king [3] to discern good and bad: and Jehovah thy God be with thee.

18 Then the king answered and said unto the woman, Hide not from me, I pray thee, aught that I shall ask thee. And the woman said, Let my lord the king now speak. 19 And the king said, Is the hand of Joab with thee in all this? And the woman answered and said, As thy soul liveth, my lord the king, none can turn to the right hand or to the left from aught that my lord the king hath spoken; for [m] thy servant Joab, he bade me, and he put all these words in the mouth of thy handmaid; 20 to change the face of the matter hath thy servant Joab done this thing: and my lord is wise, [n] according to the wisdom of [2] an angel of God, to know all things that are in the earth.

21 And the king said unto Joab, Behold now, [4] [o] I have done this thing: go therefore, bring the young man Absalom back. 22 And Joab fell to the ground on his face, and did obeisance, and blessed the king; and Joab said, To-day thy servant knoweth that I have found favor in thy sight, my lord, O king, in that the king hath performed the request of [5] his servant. 23 So Joab arose and went to [p] Geshur, and brought Absalom to Jerusalem. 24 And the king said, Let him turn to [q] his own house, but let him not see my face. So Absalom turned to his own house, and saw not the king's face.

25 Now in all Israel there was none to be so much praised as Absalom for his beauty: [r] from the sole of his foot even to the crown of his head there was no blemish in him. 26 And when he [s] cut the hair of his head (now it was at every year's end that he cut it; because it was heavy on him, therefore he cut it); he weighed the hair of his head at two hundred shekels, after the king's weight. 27 And [t] unto Absalom there were born three sons, and one daughter, whose name was [u] Tamar: she was a woman of a fair countenance.

28 And Absalom dwelt two full years in Jerusalem; and [v] he saw not the king's face. 29 Then Absalom sent for Joab, to send him to the king; but he would not come to him: and he sent again a second time, but he would not come. 30 Therefore he said unto his servants, See, [x] Joab's field is near mine, and he hath barley there; go and set it on fire. And Absalom's servants set the field on

[a] Gen. 43. 9; 1 S. 25. 24
[b] 1 K. 2. 33
[c] Num. 35. 19, 21; Dt. 19. 4–10
[d] 1 S. 14. 45; 1 K. 1. 52; Mt. 10. 30
[e] ch. 12. 7; 1 K. 20. 40–42
[f] ch. 13. 37, 38
[g] Job 30. 23; 34. 15; Heb. 9. 27
[h] Ps. 58. 7
[i] Num. 35. 15, 25, 28
[k] Dt. 32. 9; 1 S. 26. 19
[l] ver. 20; ch. 19. 27; 1 S. 29. 9
[m] ver. 3
[n] ver. 17; ch. 19. 27
[o] ver. 11
[p] ch. 13. 37, 38
[q] ch. 13. 20
[r] Dt. 28. 35; Job 2. 7; Is. 1. 6
[s] Ezek. 44. 20
[t] ch. 18. 18
[u] ch. 13. 1
[v] ver. 24
[x] Judg. 15. 3–6

[1] Heb. *for rest.* [2] Or, *the* [3] Heb. *to hear.*
[4] Another reading is, *thou hast done.*
[5] Another reading is, *thy.*

fire. 31 Then Joab arose, and came to Absalom unto his house, and said unto him, Wherefore have thy servants set my field on fire? 32 And Absalom answered Joab, Behold, I sent unto thee, saying, Come hither, that I may send thee to the king, to say, Wherefore am I come from Geshur? it were better for me to be there still. Now therefore let me see the king's face; [a] and if there be iniquity in me, let him kill me. 33 So Joab came to the king, and told him; and when he had called for Absalom, he came to the king, and bowed himself on his face to the ground before the king: and [b] the king kissed Absalom.

15 And it came to pass after this, that [c] Absalom prepared him a chariot and horses, and fifty men to run before him. 2 And Absalom rose up early, and [d] stood beside the way of the gate: and it was so, that, when any man had a suit which should come to the king for judgment, then Absalom called unto him, and said, Of what city art thou? And he said, Thy servant is of one of the tribes of Israel. 3 And Absalom said unto him, See, thy matters are good and right; but there is no man deputed of the king to hear thee. 4 Absalom said moreover, [e] Oh that I were made judge in the land, that every man who hath any suit or cause might come unto me, and I would do him justice! 5 And it was so, that, when any man came nigh to do him obeisance, he put forth his hand, and took hold of him, and [f] kissed him. 6 And on this manner did Absalom to all Israel that came to the king for judgment: so Absalom stole the hearts of the men of Israel.

7 And it came to pass at the end of [1] forty years, that Absalom said unto the king, I pray thee, let me go and pay my vow, which I have vowed unto Jehovah, in [g] Hebron. 8 For thy servant [h] vowed a vow while I abode at Geshur in [2] Syria, saying, [i] If Jehovah shall indeed bring me again to Jerusalem, then I will [3] serve Jehovah. 9 And the king said unto him, Go in peace. So he arose, and went to Hebron. 10 But Absalom sent spies throughout all the tribes of Israel, saying, As soon as ye hear the sound of the trumpet, then ye shall say, [k] Absalom is king in Hebron. 11 And with Absalom went two hundred men out of Jerusalem, [l] that were invited, and [m] went in their simplicity; and they knew not anything. 12 And Absalom [4] sent for [n] Ahithophel the Gilonite, David's counsellor, from his city, even from [o] Giloh, while he was offering the sacrifices. And the conspiracy was strong; for [p] the people increased continually with Absalom.

13 And there came a messenger to David, saying, [q] The hearts of the men of Israel are after Absalom. 14 And David said unto all his servants that were with him at Jerusalem, [r] Arise, and let us flee; for else none of us shall escape from Absalom: make speed to depart, lest he overtake us quickly, and bring down evil upon us, and smite the city with the edge of the sword. 15 And the king's servants said unto the king, Behold, thy servants are ready to do whatsoever my lord the king shall choose. 16 And the king went forth, and all his household after him. And [s] the king left ten women, that were concubines, to keep the house. 17 And the king went forth, and all the people after him; and they tarried [5] in Beth-merhak. 18 And all his servants passed on beside him; and [t] all the Cherethites, and all the Pelethites, and all the Gittites, [u] six hundred men that came after him from Gath, passed on before the king.

19 Then said the king to [v] Ittai the Gittite, Wherefore goest thou also with us? return, and abide with the king: for thou art a foreigner, and also an exile; *return* to thine own place. 20 Whereas thou camest but yesterday, should I this day make thee go up and down with us, seeing [x] I go whither I may? return thou, and take back thy brethren; [y] mercy and truth be with thee. 21 And Ittai answered the king, and said, [z] As Jehovah liveth, and as my lord the king liveth, surely in what place my lord the king shall be, whether for death or for life, even there also will thy servant be. 22 And David said to Ittai, Go and pass over. And Ittai

[a] 1 S. 20. 8
[b] Gen. 33. 4; Lk. 15. 20
[c] 1 K. 1. 5
[d] ch. 19. 8; Ruth 4. 1
[e] Judg. 9. 1-5, 29
[f] ch. 14. 33; 20. 9
[g] ch. 3. 2, 3
[h] ch. 13. 37, 38
[i] Gen. 28. 20, 21

[k] 1 K. 1. 34; 2 K. 9. 13
[l] 1 S. 9. 13
[m] 1 S. 22. 15
[n] ver. 31
[o] Josh. 15. 51
[p] Ps. 3. 1
[q] ver. 6; Judg. 9. 3
[r] ch. 12. 11; Ps. 3. title

[s] ch. 16. 21, 22

[t] ch. 8. 18

[u] 1 S. 23. 13; 25. 13; 30. 1, 9

[v] ch. 18. 2

[x] 1 S. 23. 13

[y] ch. 2. 6

[z] Ruth 1. 16, 17

[1] According to Syr. and some editions of Sept., *four.* [2] Heb. *Aram.* [3] Or, *worship*

[4] Or, *sent Ahithophel* [5] Or, *at the Far House*

the Gittite passed over, and all his men, and all the little ones that were with him. 23 And all the country wept with a loud voice, and all the people passed over: the king also himself passed over [a] the brook Kidron, and all the people passed over, toward [b] the way of the wilderness.

24 And, lo, [c] Zadok also *came*, and all the Levites with him, [d] bearing the ark of the covenant of God: and they set down the ark of God; and [e] Abiathar went up, until all the people had done passing out of the city. 25 And the king said unto Zadok, Carry back the ark of God into the city: if I shall find favor in the eyes of Jehovah, [f] he will bring me again, and show me both it, and [g] his habitation: 26 but if he say thus, [h] I have no delight in thee; behold, here am I, [i] let him do to me as seemeth good unto him. 27 The king said also unto Zadok the priest, [1] Art thou *not* [k] a seer? return into the city in peace, and your [l] two sons with you, Ahimaaz thy son, and Jonathan the son of Abiathar. 28 See, I will tarry [2] [m] at the fords of the wilderness, until there come word from you to certify me. 29 Zadok therefore and Abiathar carried the ark of God again to Jerusalem: and they abode there.

30 And David went up by the ascent of the *mount of* Olives, and wept as he went up; and he had [n] his head covered, and went [o] barefoot: and all the people that were with him covered every man his head, and they went up, weeping as they went up. 31 And one told David, saying, [p] Ahithophel is among the conspirators with Absalom. And David said, O Jehovah, I pray thee, [q] turn the counsel of Ahithophel into foolishness. 32 And it came to pass, that, when David was come to the top *of the ascent*, [3] where God was worshipped, behold, Hushai the [r] Archite came to meet him with his coat rent, and earth upon his head. 33 And David said unto him, If thou passest on with me, then thou wilt be [s] a burden unto me: 34 but if thou return to the city, and [t] say unto Absalom, I will be thy servant, O king; as I have been thy father's servant in time past, so will I now be thy servant; then wilt thou defeat for me the counsel of Ahithophel. 35 And hast thou not there with thee Zadok and Abiathar the priests? therefore it shall be, that [u] what thing soever thou shalt hear out of the king's house, thou shalt tell it to Zadok and Abiathar the priests. 36 Behold, they have there with them [v] their two sons, Ahimaaz, Zadok's son, and Jonathan, Abiathar's son; and [x] by them ye shall send unto me everything that ye shall hear. 37 So Hushai, [y] David's friend, came into the city; and [z] Absalom came into Jerusalem.

16 And when David was [a] a little past the top *of the ascent*, behold, [b] Ziba the servant of Mephibosheth met him, [c] with a couple of asses saddled, and upon them two hundred loaves of bread, and a hundred clusters of raisins, and a hundred of summer fruits, and a [4] bottle of wine. 2 And the king said unto Ziba, What meanest thou by these? And Ziba said, [d] The asses are for the king's household to ride on; and the bread and summer fruit for the young men to eat; and the wine, that [e] such as are faint in the wilderness may drink. 3 And the king said, And where is [f] thy master's son? And [g] Ziba said unto the king, Behold, he abideth at Jerusalem; for he said, To-day will the house of Israel restore me the kingdom of my father. 4 Then said the king to Ziba, Behold, thine is all that pertaineth unto Mephibosheth. And Ziba said, I do obeisance; let me find favor in thy sight, my lord, O king.

5 And when king David came to [h] Bahurim, behold, there came out thence a man of the family of the house of Saul, [i] whose name was Shimei, the son of Gera; he came out, and [k] cursed still as he came. 6 And he cast stones at David, and at all the servants of king David: and all the people and all the mighty men were on his right hand and on his left. 7 And thus said Shimei when he cursed, Begone, begone, [l] thou man of blood, and base fellow: 8 [m] Jehovah hath returned upon thee all the blood of the house of Saul, in whose stead thou hast reigned; and Jehovah hath delivered the kingdom into the hand of Absalom thy son; and,

[a] 1 K. 15. 13; 2 Chr. 29. 16
[b] ver. 28; ch. 16. 2
[c] ch. 8. 17; 20. 25
[d] Num. 4. 15; 1 S. 4. 4, 5
[e] 1 S. 22. 20
[f] Ps. 43. 3
[g] Ex. 15. 13; Jer. 25. 30
[h] 2 S. 11. 27; 1 Chr. 21. 7
[i] 1 S. 3. 18
[k] 1 S. 9. 6–9
[l] ch. 17. 17
[m] ch. 17. 16; Josh. 5. 10
[n] Esth. 6. 12; Ezek. 24. 17, 23
[o] Is. 20. 2–4
[p] ver. 12
[q] ch. 16. 23; 17. 14, 23
[r] Josh. 16. 2
[s] ch. 19. 35
[t] ch. 16. 19

[u] ch. 17. 15, 16
[v] ver. 27
[x] ch. 17. 17
[y] ch. 16. 16; 1 Chr. 27. 33
[z] ch. 16. 15
[a] ch. 15. 32
[b] ch. 9. 2–13
[c] 1 S. 25. 18
[d] Judg. 10. 4
[e] ch. 17. 29
[f] ch. 9. 9, 10
[g] ch. 19. 26, 27

[h] ch. 3. 16; 17. 18
[i] ch. 19. 16–23; 1 K. 2. 8, 9, 44
[k] Ex. 22. 28; 1 S. 17. 43

[l] ch. 12. 9
[m] ch. 21. 1–9

1 Or, *Seest thou?*
2 Another reading is, *in the plains.*
3 Or, *where he was wont to worship God*
4 Or, *skin*

behold, thou art *taken* in thine own mischief, because thou art a man of blood.

9 Then [a] said Abishai the son of Zeruiah unto the king, Why should [b] this dead dog [c] curse my lord the king? let me go over, I pray thee, and take off his head. 10 And the king said, [d] What have I to do with you, ye sons of Zeruiah? [1] [e] Because he curseth, and because Jehovah hath said unto him, Curse David; [f] who then shall say, Wherefore hast thou done so? 11 And David said to Abishai, and to all his servants, Behold, [g] my son, who came forth from my bowels, seeketh my life: how much more *may* this Benjamite now *do it*? let him alone, and let him curse; [h] for Jehovah hath bidden him. 12 It may be that Jehovah will look on the wrong done unto me, and [i] that Jehovah will requite me good for *his* cursing of me this day. 13 So David and his men went by the way; and Shimei went along on the hillside over against him, and cursed as he went, and threw stones [2] at him, and cast dust. 14 And the king, and all the people that were with him, came [3] weary; and he refreshed himself there.

15 [k] And Absalom, and all the people, the men of Israel, came to Jerusalem, and Ahithophel with him. 16 And it came to pass, when [l] Hushai the Archite, David's friend, was come unto Absalom, that [m] Hushai said unto Absalom, [n] *Long* live the king, *Long* live the king. 17 And Absalom said to Hushai, Is this thy kindness to thy friend? [o] why wentest thou not with thy friend? 18 And Hushai said unto Absalom, Nay; but whom Jehovah, and this people, and all the men of Israel have chosen, his will I be, and with him will I abide. 19 And again, [p] whom should I serve? *should I* not *serve* in the presence of his son? as I have served in thy father's presence, so will I be in thy presence.

20 Then said Absalom to Ahithophel, Give your counsel what we shall do. 21 And Ahithophel said unto Absalom, [q] Go in unto thy father's concubines, that he hath left to keep the house; and all Israel will hear that thou art abhorred of thy father: then will the hands of all that are with thee be strong. 22 So they spread Absalom a tent upon the top of the house; [r] and Absalom went in unto his father's concubines [s] in the sight of all Israel. 23 And [t] the counsel of Ahithophel, which he gave in those days, was as if a man inquired at the [4] oracle of God: [u] so was all the counsel of Ahithophel both with David and with Absalom.

17 Moreover Ahithophel said unto Absalom, Let me now choose out twelve thousand men, and I will arise and pursue after David this night: 2 and [v] I will come upon him while he is weary and weak-handed, and will make him afraid; and all the people that are with him shall flee; and [x] I will smite the king only; 3 and I will bring back all the people unto thee: the man whom thou seekest is as if all returned: *so* all the people shall be in peace. 4 And the saying pleased Absalom well, and all the elders of Israel.

5 Then said Absalom, Call now [y] Hushai the Archite also, and let us hear likewise what he saith. 6 And when Hushai was come to Absalom, Absalom spake unto him, saying, Ahithophel hath spoken after this manner: shall we do *after* his saying? if not, speak thou. 7 And Hushai said unto Absalom, [z] The counsel that Ahithophel hath given this time is not good. 8 Hushai said moreover, Thou knowest thy father and his men, that they are mighty men, and they are [5] chafed in their minds, [a] as a bear robbed of her whelps in the field; and thy father is a [b] man of war, and will not lodge with the people. 9 Behold, he is hid now in some pit, or in some *other* place: and it will come to pass, [6] when some of them are fallen at the first, that whosoever heareth it will say, There is a slaughter among the people that follow Absalom. 10 And even he that is valiant, whose heart is as the heart of a lion, [c] will utterly melt; for all Israel knoweth that thy father is a mighty man, and they that are with him are valiant men. 11 But I counsel that all Israel be gathered together unto thee, [d] from Dan even

[a] ch. 19. 21; 1 S. 26. 8; Lk. 9. 54
[b] ch. 9. 8
[c] Ex. 22. 28
[d] ch. 3. 39; 19. 22
[e] Jn. 18. 11
[f] Rom. 9. 20
[g] ch. 12. 11
[h] Gen. 45. 5; 1 S. 26. 19
[i] Dt. 23. 5; Rom. 8. 28
[k] ch. 15. 12, 37
[l] ch. 15. 37
[m] ch. 15. 34
[n] 1 S. 10. 24; 2 K. 11. 12
[o] ch. 19. 25
[p] ch. 15. 34
[q] ch. 15. 16

[r] ch. 15. 16; 20. 3
[s] ch. 12. 11, 12
[t] ch. 17. 14, 23
[u] ch. 15. 12
[v] ch. 16. 14
[x] 1 K. 22. 31

[y] ch. 15. 32–34

[z] ch. 16. 21

[a] Prov. 17. 12; Hos. 13. 8
[b] 1 S. 16. 18; 1 Chr. 22. 8

[c] Josh. 2. 9–11

[d] 1 S. 3. 20

[1] Or, *When he curseth, and when &c.* Another reading is, *So let him curse, because.*
[2] Heb. *over against.* [3] Or, *to Ayephim*
[4] Heb. *word.* [5] Heb. *bitter of soul.*
[6] Or, *when he falleth upon them*

to Beer-sheba, [a] as the sand that is by the sea for multitude; and [1] that thou go to battle in thine own person. 12 So shall we come upon him in some place where he shall be found, and we will light upon him [b] as the dew falleth on the ground; and of him and of all the men that are with him we will not leave so much as one. 13 Moreover, if he [2] be gotten into a city, then shall all Israel bring ropes to that city, and we will [c] draw it into the river, until there be not one small stone found there. 14 And Absalom and all the men of Israel said, The counsel of Hushai the Archite is better than the counsel of Ahithophel. For [d] Jehovah had ordained to defeat the good counsel of Ahithophel, to the intent that Jehovah might bring evil upon Absalom.

15 Then [e] said Hushai unto Zadok and to Abiathar the priests, Thus and thus did Ahithophel counsel Absalom and the elders of Israel; and thus and thus have I counselled. 16 Now therefore send quickly, and tell David, saying, [f] Lodge not this night [3] at the fords of the wilderness, but by all means pass over; lest the king be swallowed up, and all the people that are with him. 17 [4g] Now Jonathan and Ahimaaz were staying by [h] Enrogel; and a maid-servant used to go and tell them; and they went and told king David: for they might not be seen to come into the city. 18 But a lad saw them, and told Absalom: and they went both of them away quickly, and came to the house of a man [i] in Bahurim, who had a well in his court; and they went down thither. 19 And [k] the woman took and spread the covering over the well's mouth, and strewed bruised grain thereon; and nothing was known. 20 And Absalom's servants came to the woman to the house; and they said, Where are Ahimaaz and Jonathan? And [l] the woman said unto them, They are gone over the brook of water. And when they had sought and could not find them, they returned to Jerusalem.

21 And it came to pass, after they were departed, that they came up out of the well, and went and told king David; and they said unto David, [m] Arise ye, and pass quickly over the water; for thus hath Ahithophel counselled against you. 22 Then David arose, and all the people that were with him, and they passed over the Jordan: by the morning light there lacked not one of them that was not gone over the Jordan. 23 And when Ahithophel saw that his counsel was not followed, he saddled his ass, and arose, and gat him home, unto [n] his city, and [o] set his house in order, and [p] hanged himself; and he died, and was buried in the sepulchre of his father.

24 Then David came to [q] Mahanaim. And Absalom passed over the Jordan, he and all the men of Israel with him. 25 And Absalom set [r] Amasa over the host instead of Joab. Now Amasa was the son of a man, whose name was [5] Ithra the Israelite, that went in to [6] Abigal the daughter of [s] Nahash, sister to Zeruiah, Joab's mother. 26 And Israel and Absalom encamped in the land of Gilead.

27 And it came to pass, when David was come to Mahanaim, that [t] Shobi the son of Nahash of [u] Rabbah of the children of Ammon, and [v] Machir the son of Ammiel of Lo-debar, and [x] Barzillai the Gileadite of Rogelim, 28 brought beds, and basins, and earthen vessels, and wheat, and barley, and meal, and parched *grain*, and beans, and lentils, and parched *pulse*, 29 and honey, and butter, and sheep, and cheese of the herd, for David, and for the people that were with him, to eat: for they said, The people are hungry, and weary, and thirsty, [y] in the wilderness.

18 And David numbered the people that were with him, and [z] set captains of thousands and captains of hundreds over them. 2 And David sent forth the people, [a] a third part under the hand of Joab, and a third part under the hand of Abishai the son of Zeruiah, Joab's brother, and a third part under the hand of [b] Ittai the Gittite. And the king said unto the people, I will surely go forth with you myself also. 3 But the people said,

[a] Gen. 22. 17; 1 S. 13. 5
[b] Ps. 110. 3; Mic. 5. 7
[c] Mic. 1. 6
[d] ch. 15. 31, 34
[e] ch. 15. 35, 36
[f] ch. 15, 28
[g] ch. 15. 27, 36
[h] Josh. 15. 7; 18. 16
[i] ch. 3. 16; 16. 5
[k] Josh. 2. 4–6
[l] Lev. 19. 11; Josh. 2. 3–5; 1 S. 19. 12–17

[m] ver. 15, 16
[n] ch. 15. 12
[o] 2 K. 20. 1
[p] Mt. 27. 5
[q] ch. 2. 8; Gen. 32. 2, 10

[r] ch. 19. 13; 20. 9–12; 1 K. 2. 5, 32

[s] 1 Chr. 2. 13, 16

[t] ch. 10. 1, 2; 1 S. 11. 1
[u] ch. 12. 26, 29
[v] ch. 9. 4
[x] ch. 19. 31–40; 1 K. 2. 7

[y] ch. 16. 2, 14

[z] Ex. 18. 25; Num. 31. 14; 1 S. 22. 7
[a] Judg. 7. 16; 1 S. 11. 11

[b] ch. 15. 19–22

[1] Or, *that thy presence* (Heb. *face*) *go to the battle* [2] Or, *withdraw himself*
[3] Another reading is, *in the plains.*
[4] Or, *Now Jonathan and Ahimaaz are staying by Enrogel; so let the maid-servant go and tell them, and let them go and tell king David; for they may not be seen to come into the city*
[5] In 1 Chr. 2. 17, *Jether the Ishmaelite.*
[6] In 1 Chr. 2. 16, 17, *Abigail.*

[a] Thou shalt not go forth: for if we flee away, they will not care for us; neither if half of us die, will they care for us: [1] but thou art worth ten thousand of us; therefore now it is better that thou be ready to succor us out of the city. 4 And the king said unto them, What seemeth you best I will do. And [b] the king stood by the gate-side, and all the people went out by hundreds and by thousands. 5 And the king commanded Joab and Abishai and Ittai, saying, Deal gently for my sake with the young man, even with Absalom. And [c] all the people heard when the king gave all the captains charge concerning Absalom.

6 So the people went out into the field against Israel: and the battle was in [d] the forest of Ephraim. 7 And the people of Israel were smitten there before the servants of David, and there was a great slaughter there that day of twenty thousand men. 8 For the battle was there spread over the face of all the country; and the forest devoured more people that day than the sword devoured.

9 And Absalom chanced to meet the servants of David. And Absalom was riding upon his mule, and the mule went under the thick boughs of a great [2] oak, and [e] his head caught hold of the oak, and he was taken up between heaven and earth; and the mule that was under him went on. 10 And a certain man saw it, and told Joab, and said, Behold, I saw Absalom hanging in an oak. 11 And Joab said unto the man that told him, And, behold, thou sawest it, and why didst thou not smite him there to the ground? and I would have given thee ten *pieces of* silver, and a girdle. 12 And the man said unto Joab, Though I should receive a thousand *pieces of* silver in my hand, yet would I not put forth my hand against the king's son: for [f] in our hearing the king charged thee and Abishai and Ittai, saying, [3] Beware that none touch the young man Absalom. 13 Otherwise if I had dealt falsely against [4] his life (and [g] there is no matter hid from the king), then thou thyself would-

[a] ch. 21. 17
[b] ver. 24
[c] ver. 12
[d] ch. 17. 26; Josh. 17. 15, 18
[e] ch. 14. 26
[f] ver. 5
[g] ch. 14. 19, 20

[h] ch. 14. 30
[i] ch. 2. 28; 20. 22

[k] Dt. 21. 20, 21; Josh. 7. 26; 8. 29
[l] ch. 19. 8; 20. 1, 22
[m] 1 S. 15. 12
[n] Gen. 14. 17
[o] ch. 14. 27

[p] ch. 15. 36

[q] ver. 31

[r] ver. 29

[s] ch. 19. 8
[t] ch. 13. 34; 2 K. 9. 17

est have set thyself against *me*. 14 Then said Joab, I may not tarry thus with thee. [h] And he took three [5] darts in his hand, and thrust them through the heart of Absalom, while he was yet alive in the midst of the oak. 15 And ten young men that bare Joab's armor compassed about and smote Absalom, and slew him.

16 And [i] Joab blew the trumpet, and the people returned from pursuing after Israel; for Joab [6] held back the people. 17 And they took Absalom, and cast him into the great pit in the forest, and [k] raised over him a very great heap of stones: and [l] all Israel fled every one to his tent. 18 Now Absalom in his lifetime had taken and [m] reared up for himself the pillar, which is in [n] the king's dale; for he said, [o] I have no son to keep my name in remembrance: and he called the pillar after his own name; and it is called Absalom's monument, unto this day.

19 Then said [p] Ahimaaz the son of Zadok, Let me now run, and bear the king tidings, [q] how that Jehovah hath [7] avenged him of his enemies. 20 And Joab said unto him, Thou shalt not be the bearer of tidings this day, but thou shalt bear tidings another day; but this day thou shalt bear no tidings, because the king's son is dead. 21 Then said Joab to the Cushite, Go, tell the king what thou hast seen. And the Cushite bowed himself unto Joab, and ran. 22 Then said Ahimaaz the son of Zadok yet again to Joab, But come what may, let me, I pray thee, also run after the Cushite. And Joab said, Wherefore wilt thou run, my son, seeing that [r] thou [8] wilt have no reward for the tidings? 23 But come what may, *said he*, I will run. And he said unto him, Run. Then Ahimaaz ran by the way of the Plain, and outran the Cushite.

24 Now [s] David was sitting between the two gates: and [t] the watchman went up to the roof of the gate unto the wall, and lifted up his eyes, and looked, and, behold, a man running alone. 25 And the watchman cried, and told the king. And the king said, If he be alone, there is tidings in his mouth. And he came apace, and

[1] So Vulg. and some editions of Sept. The Hebrew text has, *for now are there ten thousand such as we.* [2] Or, *terebinth*
[3] Heb. *Have a care, whosoever ye be, of &c.*
[4] Another reading is, *my.*
[5] Heb. *staves.* [6] Or, *spared*
[7] Heb. *judged him from the hand &c.*
[8] Or, *hast no sufficient tidings*

drew near. 26 And the watchman saw another man running; and the watchman called unto the porter, and said, Behold, *another* man running alone. And the king said, He also bringeth tidings. 27 And the watchman said, I think the running of the foremost [a] is like the running of Ahimaaz the son of Zadok. And the king said, [b] He is a good man, and cometh with good tidings.

28 And Ahimaaz called, and said unto the king, [1] All is well. And [c] he bowed himself before the king with his face to the earth, and said, [d] Blessed be Jehovah thy God, who hath delivered up the men that lifted up their hand against my lord the king. 29 And the king said, [2] [e] Is it well with the young man Absalom? And Ahimaaz answered, When Joab sent the king's servant, [3] even me thy servant, I saw a great tumult, but [f] I knew not what it was. 30 And the king said, Turn aside, and stand here. And he turned aside, and stood still.

31 And, behold, the Cushite came; and the Cushite said, Tidings for my lord the king; for Jehovah hath avenged thee this day of all them that rose up against thee. 32 And the king said unto the Cushite, [h] Is it well with the young man Absalom? And the Cushite answered, [i] The enemies of my lord the king, and all that rise up against thee to do thee hurt, be as that young man is. *33 And the king was much moved, and went up to the chamber over the gate, and wept: and as he went, thus he said, [k] O my son Absalom, my son, my son Absalom! [l] would I had died for thee, O Absalom, my son, my son!

19 And it was told Joab, Behold, [m] the king weepeth and mourneth for Absalom. 2 And the [4] victory that day was turned into mourning unto all the people; for the people heard say that day, The king grieveth for his son. 3 And the people gat them by stealth that day into the city, as people that are ashamed steal away when they flee in battle. 4 And the king [n] covered his face, and the king cried with a loud voice, [o] O my son Absalom, O Absalom, my son, my son! 5 And Joab came into the house to the king, and said, Thou hast shamed this day the faces of all thy servants, who this day have saved thy life, and the lives of thy sons and of thy daughters, and the lives of thy wives, and the lives of thy concubines; 6 in that thou lovest them that hate thee, and hatest them that love thee. For thou hast declared this day, that princes and servants are nought unto thee: for this day I perceive, that if Absalom had lived, and all we had died this day, then it had pleased thee well. 7 Now therefore arise, go forth, and speak comfortably unto thy servants; for I swear by Jehovah, if thou go not forth, there will not tarry a man with thee this night: and that will be worse unto thee than all the evil that hath befallen thee from thy youth until now. 8 Then the king arose, and sat in the gate. And they told unto all the people, saying, Behold, the king is [p] sitting in the gate: and all the people came before the king.

Now [q] Israel had fled every man to his tent. 9 And all the people were at strife throughout all the tribes of Israel, saying, [r] The king delivered us out of the hand of our enemies, and [s] he saved us out of the hand of the Philistines; and now [t] he is fled out of the land from Absalom. 10 And Absalom, whom we anointed over us, is dead in battle. Now therefore why speak ye not a word of bringing the king back?

11 And [u] king David sent to Zadok and to Abiathar the priests, saying, Speak unto the elders of Judah, saying, Why are ye the last to bring the king back to his house? seeing the speech of all Israel is come to the king, *to bring him* to his house. 12 Ye are my brethren, [v] ye are my bone and my flesh: wherefore then are ye the last to bring back the king? 13 And [x] say ye to Amasa, Art thou not my bone and my flesh? [y] God do so to me, and more also, if thou be not [z] captain of the host before me continually [a] in the room of Joab. 14 And he bowed the heart of all the men of Judah, even [b] as *the heart of* one man; so that they sent unto the king, *saying*, Return thou, and all thy servants. 15 So the king returned, and came to the

[a] 2 K. 9. 20
[b] 1 K. 1. 42
[c] ch. 14. 4; 1 S. 25. 23
[d] 1 S. 17. 46
[e] ch. 20. 9; 2 K. 4. 26
[f] ver. 22
[g] ver. 19; Judg. 5. 31
[h] ver. 29
[i] 1 S. 25. 26
[k] ch. 19. 4
[l] Ex. 32. 32; Rom. 9. 3
[m] ch. 18. 5, 14
[n] ch. 15. 30
[o] ch. 18. 33

[p] ch. 15. 2; 18. 24
[q] ch. 18. 17
[r] ch. 8. 1-14
[s] ch. 5. 20; 8. 1
[t] ch. 15. 14
*[Ch. 19. 1 in Heb.]
[u] ch. 15. 29
[v] ch. 5. 1
[x] ch. 17. 25
[y] 1 K. 19. 2
[z] ch. 8. 16
[a] ver. 5-7; ch. 3. 27-39
[b] Judg. 20. 1

[1] Heb. *Peace.* [2] Heb. Is there *peace with &c.?*
[3] Or, *and* [4] Heb. *salvation.*

Jordan. And Judah came to [a]Gilgal, to go to meet the king, to bring the king over the Jordan.

16 And [b]Shimei the son of Gera, the Benjamite, who was of Bahurim, hasted and came down with the men of Judah to meet king David. 17 And there were a thousand men of Benjamin with him, and [c]Ziba the servant of the house of Saul, and his fifteen sons and his twenty servants with him; and they went through the Jordan in the presence of the king. 18 And there went over [1]a ferry-boat to bring over the king's household, and to do what he thought good. And Shimei the son of Gera fell down before the king, when he [2]was come over the Jordan. 19 And he said unto the king, [d]Let not my lord impute iniquity unto me, neither do thou remember that which thy servant did perversely the day that my lord the king went out of Jerusalem, that the king should take it to his heart. 20 For thy servant doth know that I have sinned: therefore, behold, I am come this day [e]the first of all the house of Joseph to go down to meet my lord the king.

21 But Abishai the son of Zeruiah answered and said, [f]Shall not Shimei be put to death for this, [g]because he cursed Jehovah's anointed? 22 And David said, [h]What have I to do with you, ye sons of Zeruiah, that ye should this day be adversaries unto me? [i]shall there any man be put to death this day in Israel? for do not I know that I am this day king over Israel? 23 And the king said unto Shimei, [k]Thou shalt not die. And the king sware unto him.

24 And [l]Mephibosheth the son of Saul came down to meet the king; and [m]he had neither dressed his feet, nor trimmed his beard, nor [n]washed his clothes, from the day the king departed until the day he came home in peace. 25 And it came to pass, [3]when he was come to Jerusalem to meet the king, that the king said unto him, [o]Wherefore wentest not thou with me, Mephibosheth? 26 And he answered, My lord, O king, my servant deceived me: for thy servant said, I will saddle me an ass, that I may ride thereon, and go [4]with the king; [p]because thy servant is lame. 27 And [q]he hath slandered thy servant unto my lord the king; but my lord the king is [r]as [5]an angel of God: do therefore what is good in thine eyes. 28 For [s]all my father's house were but [6]dead men before my lord the king; [t]yet didst thou set thy servant among them that did eat at thine own table. What right therefore have I yet that I should cry any more unto the king? 29 And the king said unto him, Why speakest thou any more of thy matters? I say, Thou and Ziba divide the land. 30 And Mephibosheth said unto the king, Yea, let him take all, forasmuch as my lord the king is come in peace unto his own house.

31 And [u]Barzillai the Gileadite came down from Rogelim; and he went over the Jordan with the king, to conduct him over the Jordan. 32 Now Barzillai was a very aged man, even fourscore years old: and he had provided the king with sustenance while he lay at Mahanaim; for he was a very great man. 33 And the king said unto Barzillai, Come thou over with me, and I will sustain thee with me in Jerusalem. 34 And Barzillai said unto the king, [v]How many are the days of the years of my life, that I should go up with the king unto Jerusalem? 35 I am this day [x]fourscore years old: can I discern between good and bad? can thy servant taste what I eat or what I drink? can I hear any more [y]the voice of singing men and singing women? [z]wherefore then should thy servant be yet a burden unto my lord the king? 36 Thy servant would but just go over the Jordan with the king: and why should the king recompense it me with such a reward? 37 Let thy servant, I pray thee, turn back again, that I may die in mine own city, by the grave of my father and my mother. But behold, thy servant [a]Chimham; let him go over with my lord the king; and do to him what shall seem good unto thee. 38 And the king answered, Chimham shall go over with me, and I will do to him that which shall seem good unto thee: and whatsoever thou

[a] Josh. 5. 9; 1 S. 11. 14, 15
[b] ch. 16. 5–13; 1 K. 2. 8
[c] ver. 26, 27; ch. 16. 1–4
[d] ch. 16. 6–8; 1 S. 22. 15
[e] ch. 16. 5
[f] ch. 16. 7, 8
[g] Ex. 22. 28
[h] ch. 3. 39; 16. 9, 10
[i] 1 S. 11. 13
[k] 1 K. 2. 8
[l] ch. 9. 6–10
[m] ch. 12. 20
[n] Ex. 19. 10
[o] ch. 16. 17

[p] ch. 9. 3
[q] ch. 16. 3, 4
[r] ch. 14. 17, 20
[s] ch. 21. 6–9
[t] ch. 9. 7, 10, 13

[u] ch. 17. 27–29; 1 K. 2. 7

[v] Gen. 47. 8

[x] Ps. 90. 10

[y] Eccl. 2. 8; Is. 5. 11, 12
[z] ch. 15. 33

[a] ver. 40; 1 K. 2. 7; Jer. 41. 17

[1] Or, *the convoy* [2] Or, *would go over*
[3] Or, *when Jerusalem was come*
[4] Another reading is, *to.* [5] Or, *the*
[6] Heb. *men of death.*

shalt [1] require of me, that will I do for thee. 39 And all the people went over the Jordan, and the king went over: and the king [a] kissed Barzillai, and blessed him; and he returned unto his own place.

40 So the king went over to Gilgal, and Chimham went over with him: and all the people of Judah brought the king over, and also [b] half the people of Israel. 41 And, behold, all the men of Israel came to the king, and said unto the king, [c] Why have our brethren [d] the men of Judah stolen thee away, and brought the king, and his household, over the Jordan, and all David's men with him? 42 And all the men of Judah answered the men of Israel, Because [e] the king is near of kin to us: wherefore then are ye angry for this matter? have we eaten at all at the king's cost? or hath he given us any gift? 43 And the men of Israel answered the men of Judah, and said, [f] We have ten parts in the king, and we have also more *right* in David than ye: why then did ye despise us, [2] that our advice should not be first had in bringing back our king? And the words of the men of Judah were fiercer than the words of the men of Israel.

20 And there happened to be [g] there a base fellow, whose name was Sheba, the son of [h] Bichri, a Benjamite: and he blew the trumpet, and said, [i] We have no portion in David, neither have we inheritance in [k] the son of Jesse: [l] every man to his tents, O Israel. 2 So all the men of Israel went up from following David, and followed Sheba the son of Bichri: but the men of Judah clave unto their king, from the Jordan even to Jerusalem.

3 And David came to his house at Jerusalem; and [m] the king took the ten women his concubines, whom he had left to keep the house, and put them in ward, and provided them with sustenance, but went not in unto them. So they were shut up unto the day of their death, [3] living in widowhood.

4 Then said the king to [n] Amasa, Call me the men of Judah together within three days, and be thou here present. 5 So Amasa went to call *the men of* Judah together; but he [o] tarried longer than the set time which he had appointed him. 6 And David said to [p] Abishai, Now will Sheba the son of Bichri do us more harm than did Absalom: [q] take thou thy lord's servants, and pursue after him, lest he get him fortified cities, and escape out of our sight. 7 And there went out after him Joab's men, and [r] the Cherethites and the Pelethites, and [s] all the mighty men; and they went out of Jerusalem, to pursue after Sheba the son of Bichri. 8 When they were at the great stone which is in [t] Gibeon, Amasa came to meet them. And Joab was girded with his apparel of war that he had put on, and thereon was a girdle with a sword fastened upon his loins in the sheath thereof; and as he went forth it fell out. 9 And Joab said to Amasa, Is it well with thee, my brother? And [u] Joab took Amasa by the beard with his right hand to kiss him. 10 But Amasa took no heed to the sword that was in Joab's hand: so [v] he smote him therewith in the body, and shed out his bowels to the ground, and struck him not again; and he died.

And Joab and Abishai his brother pursued after Sheba the son of Bichri. 11 And there stood by him one of Joab's young men, and said, He that favoreth Joab, and he that is for David, [x] let him follow Joab. 12 And Amasa lay wallowing in his blood in the midst of the highway. And when the man saw that all the people stood still, he carried Amasa out of the highway into the field, and cast a garment over him, when he saw that every one that came by him stood still. 13 When he was removed out of the highway, all the people went on after Joab, to pursue after Sheba the son of Bichri.

14 And he went through all the tribes of Israel unto Abel, and to Beth-maacah, and all the [y] Berites: and they were gathered together, and went also after him. 15 And they came and besieged him in [z] Abel of Beth-maacah, and [a] they cast up a mound against the city, and it stood against the rampart; and all the people that were with

[a] ch. 14. 33; Gen. 31. 55; Ruth 1. 14
[b] ver. 9, 10
[c] Judg. 8. 1; 12. 1
[d] ver. 11, 12
[e] ver. 12
[f] ch. 5. 1; 1 K. 11. 30, 31
[g] ch. 16. 7
[h] Gen. 46. 21
[i] ch. 19. 43; 1 K. 12. 16
[k] 1 S. 22. 7–9
[l] ch. 18. 17; 1 S. 13. 2; 2 Chr. 10. 16
[m] ch. 15. 16; 16. 21, 22
[n] ch. 17. 25; 19. 13

[o] 1 S. 13. 8
[p] ch. 21. 17
[q] ch. 11. 11; 1 K. 1. 33
[r] ch. 8. 18; 1 K. 1. 38
[s] ch. 15. 18
[t] ch. 2. 13; 3. 30
[u] Mt. 26. 49

[v] ch. 2. 23; 3. 27; 1 K. 2. 5

[x] ver. 13

[y] Num. 21. 16

[z] 1 K. 15. 20; 2 K. 15. 29
[a] 2 K. 19. 32; Ezek. 4. 2

[1] Heb. *choose* to lay *upon*.
[2] Or, *and were we not the first to speak of bringing back our king?*
[3] Heb. *in widowhood of life.*

Joab [1] battered the wall, to throw it down. 16 Then cried [a] a wise woman out of the city, Hear, hear; say, I pray you, unto Joab, Come near hither, that I may speak with thee. 17 And he came near unto her; and the woman said, Art thou Joab? And he answered, I am. Then she said unto him, Hear the words of thy handmaid. And he answered, I do hear. 18 Then she spake, saying, They were wont to speak in old time, saying, They shall surely ask *counsel* at Abel: and so they ended *the matter*. 19 I am of them that are peaceable and faithful in Israel: [b] thou seekest to destroy a city and a mother in Israel: why wilt thou swallow up [c] the inheritance of Jehovah? 20 And Joab answered and said, Far be it, far be it from me, that I should swallow up or destroy. 21 The matter is not so: but a man of [d] the hill-country of Ephraim, [e] Sheba the son of Bichri by name, hath lifted up his hand against the king, even against David; deliver him only, and I will depart from the city. And the woman said unto Joab, Behold, his head shall be thrown to thee over the wall. 22 Then the woman went unto all the people [f] in her wisdom. And they cut off the head of Sheba the son of Bichri, and threw it out to Joab. And [g] he blew the trumpet, and they were dispersed from the city, every man to his tent. And Joab returned to Jerusalem unto the king.

23 [h] Now Joab was over all the host of Israel; and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over the [2] Cherethites and over the Pelethites; 24 and Adoram was over the men subject to taskwork; and Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud was the [3] recorder; 25 and Sheva was [4] scribe; and Zadok and Abiathar were priests; 26 and also [i] Ira the Jairite was [5] chief minister unto David.

21 And there was [k] a famine in the days of David three years, year after year; and [l] David sought the face of Jehovah. And Jehovah said, It is for Saul, and for his bloody house, because he put to death the Gibeonites. 2 And the king called the Gibeonites, and said unto them (now the Gibeonites were not of the children of Israel, but of the remnant of the Amorites; and [m] the children of Israel had sworn unto them: and Saul sought to slay them [n] in his zeal for the children of Israel and Judah); 3 and David said unto the Gibeonites, What shall I do for you? and wherewith shall I make atonement, [o] that ye may bless the inheritance of Jehovah? 4 And the Gibeonites said unto him, [p] It is no matter of silver or gold between us and Saul, or his house; [6] neither is it for us to put any man to death in Israel. And he said, What ye shall say, that will I do for you. 5 And they said unto the king, [q] The man that consumed us, and that devised against us, [7] *that* we should be destroyed from remaining in any of the borders of Israel, 6 let seven men of his sons be delivered unto us, and we will hang them up [r] unto Jehovah in Gibeah of Saul, [s] the chosen of Jehovah. And the king said, I will give them.

7 But the king spared [t] Mephibosheth, the son of Jonathan the son of Saul, [u] because of Jehovah's oath that was between them, between David and Jonathan the son of Saul. 8 But the king took the two sons of [v] Rizpah the daughter of Aiah, whom she bare unto Saul, Armoni and Mephibosheth; and the five sons of [8] Michal the daughter of Saul, whom she bare to Adriel the son of Barzillai the [x] Meholathite: 9 and he delivered them into the hands of the Gibeonites, and they hanged them in the mountain before Jehovah, and they fell *all* seven together. And they were put to death in the days of harvest, in the first days, at [y] the beginning of barley harvest.

10 [z] And Rizpah the daughter of Aiah took sackcloth, and spread it for her upon the rock, from the beginning of harvest until water was poured upon them from heaven; and [a] she suffered neither the birds of the heavens to rest on them by day, nor the beasts of the field by night. 11 And it was told David what Rizpah the daughter of Aiah, the concubine of Saul, had done.

12 And David went and took the [b] bones of Saul and the bones of Jonathan his son from the men of

[a] ch. 14. 2
[b] Dt. 20. 10
[c] ch. 14. 16; 21. 3; 1 S. 26. 19
[d] Josh. 24. 33
[e] ver. 2
[f] ver. 16; Eccl. 9. 13–16
[g] ver. 1
[h] ch. 8. 16–18; 1 K. 4. 3–6
[i] ch. 23. 38
[k] Gen. 12. 10; 26. 1; 42. 5
[l] Num. 27. 21

[m] Josh. 9. 3, 15–20
[n] Ex. 34. 11–16; Dt. 7. 2; 1 S. 28. 3
[o] ch. 20. 19; 1 S. 26. 19
[p] Num. 35. 31, 32
[q] ver. 1

[r] Num. 25. 4
[s] 1 S. 10. 24

[t] ch. 4. 4; 9. 10
[u] 1 S. 18. 3; 20. 12–17; 23. 18

[v] ch. 3. 7

[x] 1 K. 19. 16

[y] Ex. 9. 31, 32

[z] Dt. 21. 23

[a] 1 S. 17. 44, 46

[b] 1 S. 31. 11–13

[1] Or, *undermined*
[2] Another reading is, *Carites*. See 2 K. 11. 4.
[3] Or, *chronicler* [4] Or, *secretary*
[5] Or, *priest* See 1 Chr. 18. 17.
[6] Or, *neither for us shalt thou put any man to death in Israel*
[7] Or, so that *we have been destroyed*
[8] In 1 S. 18. 19, *Merab*.